



WSQ
COURSE

COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Customer-Centric Branding and Communication Tactics

WSQ Course Code: TGS-2026061321

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

Version v8 · 11 August 2026

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

It is mandatory to take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance for WSQ-funded courses.

2

The trainer/administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.

3

Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.

4

A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template —
to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

ROLE

Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

CERTIFICATION / CREDENTIALS

20+ years of training and industry experience.

DELIVERS

WSQ courses on customer-centric branding, marketing communications and business skills.

FOUNDER

Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

Let's Know Each Other

1

Your name and organisation / role.

2

Your experience with branding, marketing or communications (if any).

3

A brand you personally admire — and why it works on you.

Ground Rules

1

Set your mobile phone to silent mode.

2

Actively participate — no question is too small.

3

Respect each other's views: agree to disagree.

4

One conversation at a time.

5

Be punctual; return from breaks on time.

6

75% attendance is required for funding eligibility.

Skills Framework

1

TSC Title

Brand Management

2

TSC Code

ICT-SNM-3002-1.1

3

Proficiency Level

Level 3

4

Structure

4 Learning Units (LU1–LU4), each mapped to a Learning Outcome.

Course Outline

1

LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Internal & External Stakeholders · Audience Types · Brand Design · Reputation Assessment

2

LU2 — Customer Influence

Customer Perceptions · Brand Reputation · Campaign Reception · Active Listening

3

LU3 — Branding in Marketing

Branding Basics · Role in Marketing · Awareness Campaigns · PR Execution

4

LU4 — Branding Effectiveness

Reputation Metrics · Success Indicators · PR Tactics · KPI Monitoring · Continuous Improvement

SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 2 Days

Day 1

- Day 1 — Stakeholders, Customer Influence & Branding in Marketing (starts)
 - LU1: Stakeholders and Organisation (Activities 1–4)
 - LU2: Customer Influence (Activities 5–8)
 - LU3: Branding in Marketing — begins (Activities 9–12)

Day 2 & Assessment

- Day 2 — Branding in Marketing (cont'd), Branding Effectiveness & Assessment
 - LU3: Branding in Marketing — continued
 - LU4: Branding Effectiveness (Activities 13–17)
 - Assessment: WA (1h) + Case Study (1h), 4:00–6:00pm
- Daily timing
 - Day 1: 9:30am–6:30pm, 1-hour lunch. Day 2: 9:30am–6:00pm, 45-min lunch (to fit the assessment).

Learning Outcomes

1

Stakeholders & Organisation

Identify stakeholders/audiences and draft branding designs & reputation assessments.

2

Customer Influence

Capture and analyse customer insight through active listening.

3

Branding in Marketing

Execute branding campaigns, events and PR activities that build awareness.

4

Branding Effectiveness

Evaluate reputation and PR performance against KPIs and recommend improvements.

Briefing for Assessment

1

Place phones and other materials under the table or on the floor.

2

No photos or recording of assessment scripts.

3

No discussion during the assessment.

4

Use a black/blue pen for hard-copy assessments.

5

No liquid paper / correction tape.

6

Scripts are collected when time is up.

Assessment

1

Written Assessment (WA) — Short-Answer Questions (SAQ), 1 hour, open book.

2

Case Study (CS) — one continuous branding scenario with open-ended tasks, 1 hour, open book.

3

Format: Open Book — slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.

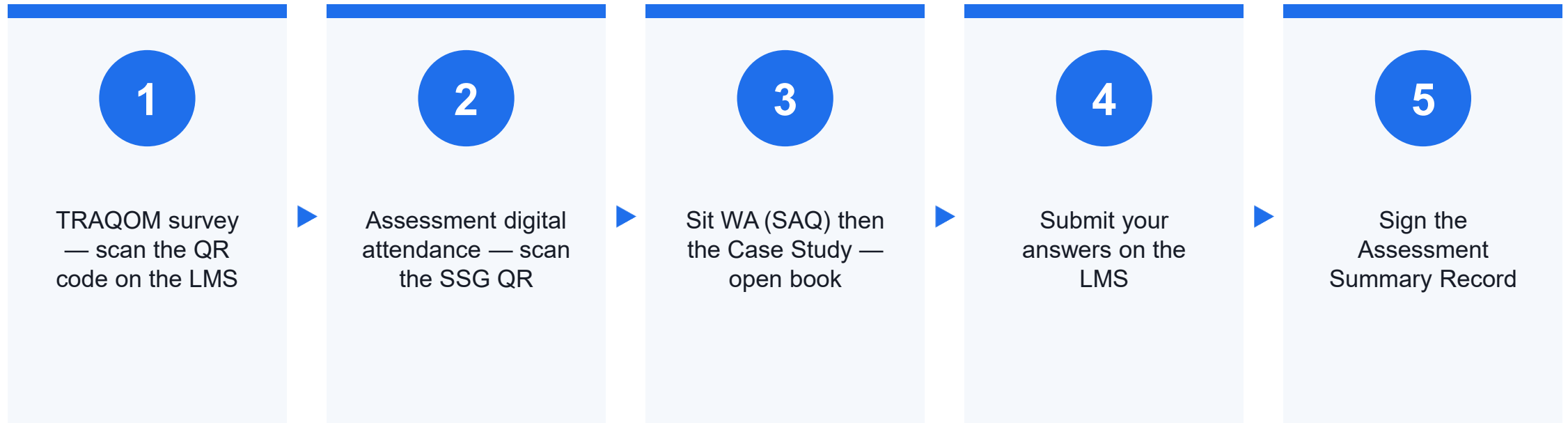
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A minimum of 75% attendance (per SSG Digital Attendance record) is required to be eligible for assessment and funding. Learners must be assessed as Competent and complete the TRAQOM survey.

5

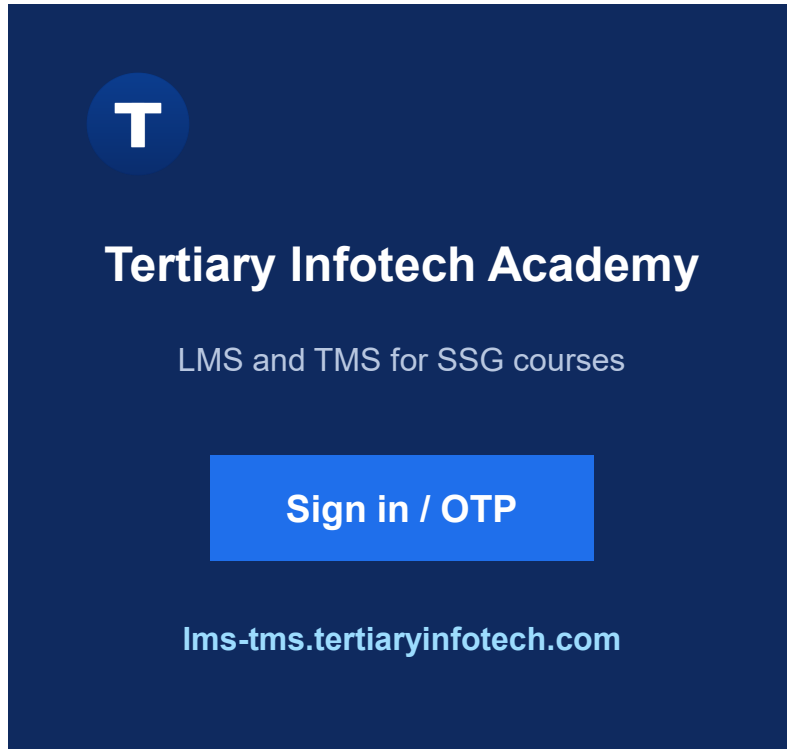
An appeal process is available if required.

Assessment Flow



Courseware & Assessment on the LMS

Everything for the open-book assessment — slides, Learner Guide and submissions — lives on the LMS.



T

Tertiary Infotech Academy

LMS and TMS for SSG courses

Sign in / OTP

lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

1

Sign in

Log in with your registered email (OTP or password).

2

Download materials

Slides and the Learner Guide from the course page — your open-book references.

3

Submit answers

Upload your Written Assessment and Case Study answers on the LMS.

4

TRAQOM survey

Complete the TRAQOM survey via the QR code shown on the LMS.

<https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>

LU1

Stakeholders and Organisation

Internal & External Stakeholders · Audience Types · Brand Design · Reputation Assessment

Key Concepts — Stakeholders and Organisation

1

Internal stakeholders (management, employees) and external stakeholders (customers, partners, investors, media) each hold a different level of influence over — and interest in — the brand.

2

External audiences segment into customers, partners, investors and media; each needs its own communication approach and message.

3

Branding designs and ideas should foreground the product or service's attributes and the concrete benefits they deliver to the audience.

4

Assessing an organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms — reviews, mentions, sentiment — is the starting point for every branding decision.

The Modern Brand Ecosystem

Four forces now shape how customers trust and choose brands.

The Shift — Philosophy

Moving from product-centric innovation to a customer-back business model (CBM) to drive sustainable growth.

The Mechanics — System

Abandoning the linear funnel for a non-linear, infinitely looping customer journey.

The Core — Emotion

Engineering authenticity and shared values as the primary engines of brand loyalty and trust.

The Scale — AI

Governing the new frontier where agentic AI acts autonomously on behalf of the brand.

The Strategic Paradigm Shift

Customer-centric organisations think, innovate and measure differently.

	Product-Centric	Customer-Centric
Core philosophy	“If we build it, they will come”	“Obsession with customer pain points and delight”
Innovation style	High-risk, creates new markets, heavy R&D	Incremental, read-and-react, user research-driven
Risk profile	High tolerance for failure and pivots	Lower risk, focused on continuous feedback loops
Success metric	One-time, big-ticket sales	Lifetime value, reduced churn, Net Promoter Scores

The Economics of Customer Obsession

Firms implementing a customer-experience (CX) approach routinely outperform product-led peers.

+49%

Faster profit growth

+41%

Higher revenue expansion

+51%

Stronger customer retention

73% of customers now expect companies to treat them as individuals, not numbers — up from just 39% in 2023.

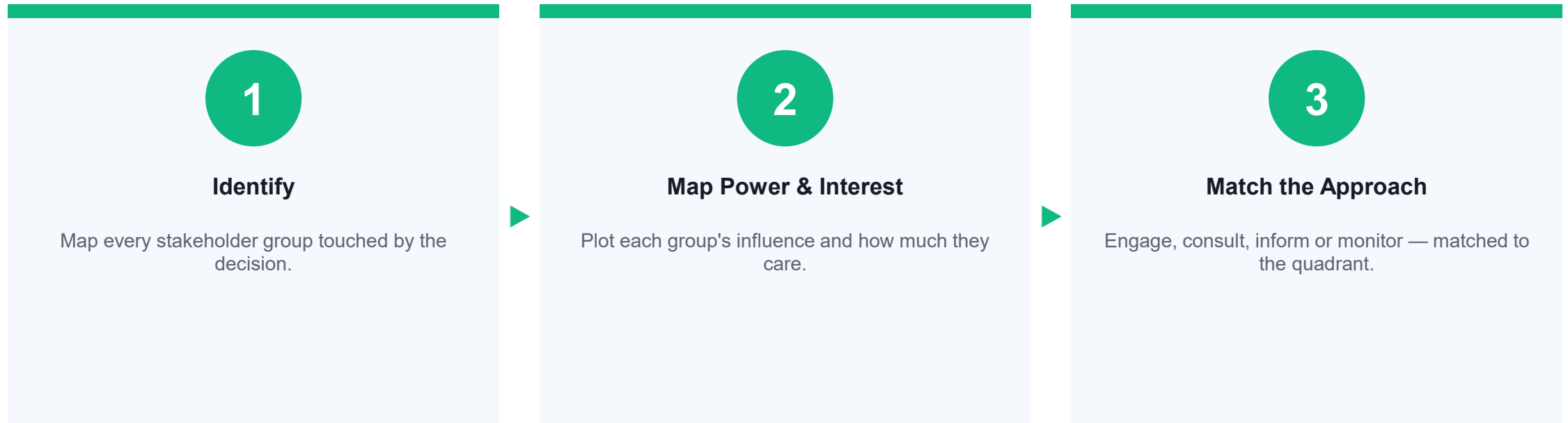
LO1 · LU1 · T1

Internal and external stakeholders influencing the brand

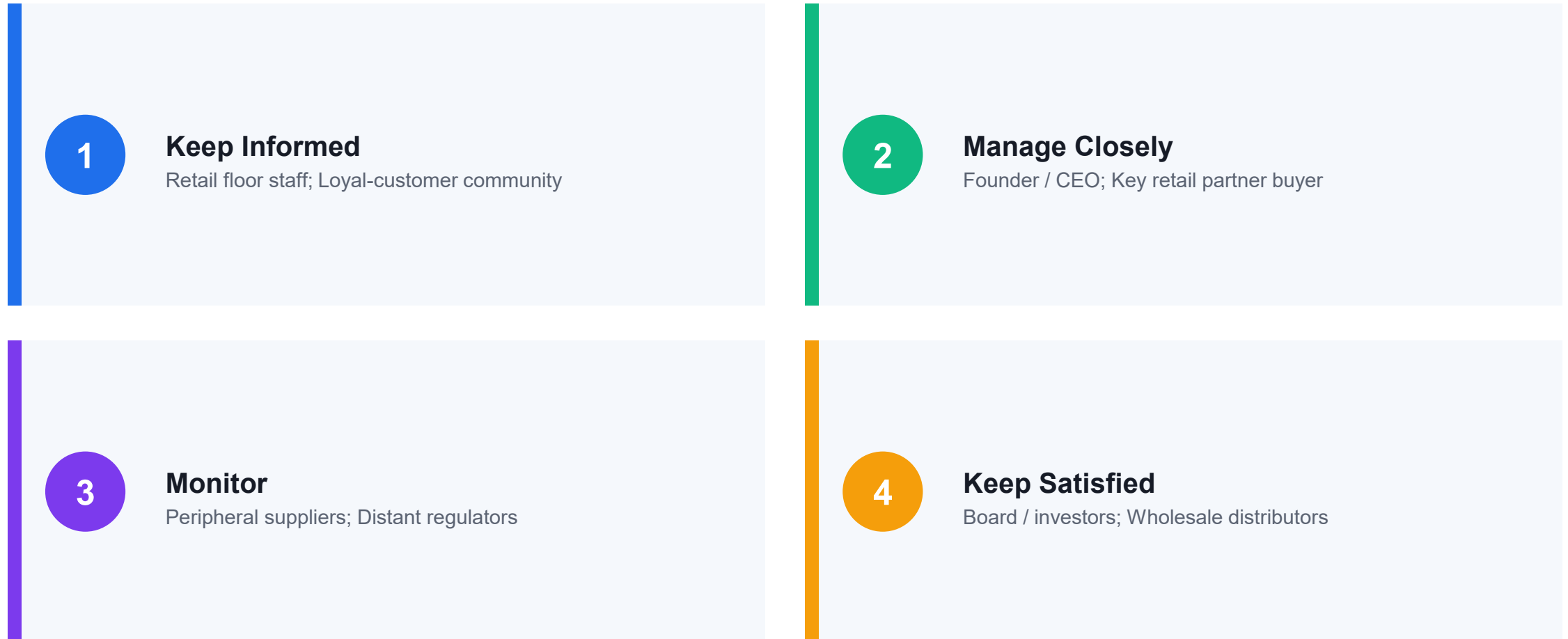
What is Internal and external stakeholders influencing the brand?



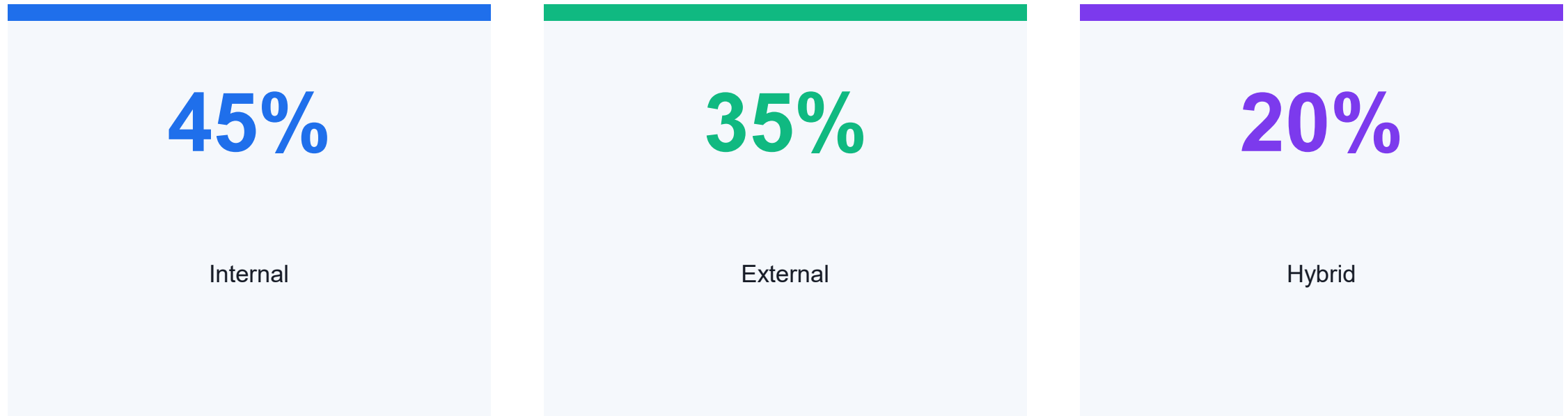
Stakeholder Management Process



Stakeholder Power-Interest Grid



Stakeholder Distribution Analysis



Source: illustrative distribution, stakeholder-mapping workshops

Internal Culture Is the First Stakeholder You Manage

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Singapore Airlines

SIA's famed inflight service isn't a customer-facing script — it's the product of decades of internal training investment. Staff who feel genuinely valued as stakeholders are the ones who convincingly make customers feel valued too.

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

Nimbus Wellness Pte Ltd, a 25-person Singapore boutique skincare and wellness brand, is three months from its 5th-anniversary relaunch. The founder has committed to a new sustainable-packaging line as the centrepiece of the relaunch story.

Not everyone is convinced. Retail operations worries the new packaging will raise unit cost and slow reorders. A wellness retail chain that carries Nimbus in 40 outlets wants proof the change won't disrupt supply before it commits fresh shelf space. Meanwhile a vocal community of long-time customers on social media is already asking why Nimbus hasn't "gone green" sooner.

Before the founder locks the relaunch brief, your table must map who genuinely has power and interest in this decision — and design how to bring each group along, not just announce it to them.

You'll produce: A stakeholder Power-Interest map (12 stakeholders) with a matched engagement approach for each quadrant

Duration: 25 minutes

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

ASSIGN THE ROLES

The Founder

GOAL

Protect the relaunch vision

Wants sustainability to be the headline story of the anniversary campaign and is impatient with anything that looks like delay.

Retail Operations Lead

GOAL

Protect margin and delivery reliability

Worried the new packaging supplier will slow reorders right before the relaunch peak season.

Retail Partner Buyer

GOAL

Protect their own shelf-space risk

Will only commit expanded shelf space once supply reliability through the transition is proven.

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Which 6 internal and 6 external stakeholders matter most to this relaunch decision, and why?

2

Using the Power-Interest Grid, where does each stakeholder sit — and which quadrant deserves your table's limited attention this month?

3

What is each stakeholder's real underlying concern, not just their stated position?

4

What engagement approach — brief, consult or co-design — fits each stakeholder's concern and influence level?

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Which stakeholder's position surprised you once you heard their actual concern instead of assuming it?
- Did power and interest always move together on your map, or did a low-power/high-interest voice turn out to be worth listening to anyway?
- If the retail partner buyer voiced hesitation publicly tomorrow, how would that change your grid?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a completed Power-Interest map with both internal and external stakeholders placed, and an engagement approach per quadrant that matches the stakeholder's real concern — not just their job title.

LO1 · LU1 · T2

Types of external audience

What is Types of external audience?

1

Customers

Prospects and loyal brand advocates

2

Partners

Business collaborators and suppliers

3

Investors

Financial stakeholders and shareholders

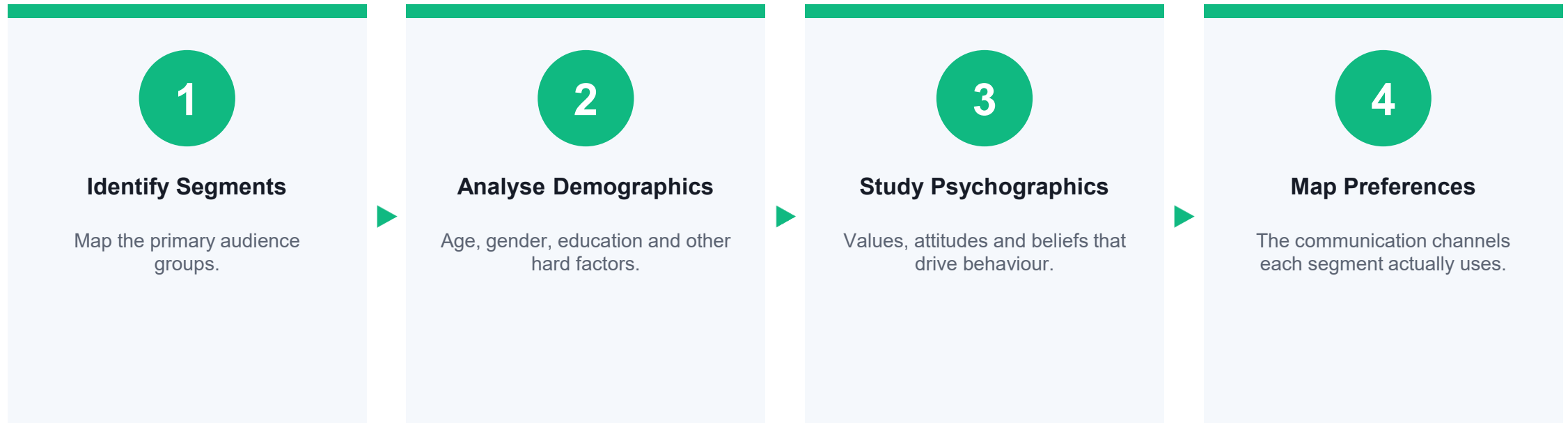
4

Media

Press and communication channels

Source: external-audience segmentation frameworks

Audience Analysis Framework



B2C vs B2B Audience Approaches

B2C — Consumers

- Emotion Driven — feeling-based purchase decisions
- Broad Reach — mass-market targeting
- Quick Decisions — impulse purchase patterns

B2B — Organisations

- Logic Driven — data-based purchase decisions
- Targeted Approach — niche market focus
- Long Process — extended, multi-stakeholder buying cycles

Two Nimbus Audience Personas

1

Amara Lim

Existing Loyal Customer — Wants: Feel like Nimbus still “gets” her; Be recognised for years of support. Concerns: New marketing feels generic; Unsure what’s actually changed

2

Wei Jie Tan

Retail Chain Buyer — Wants: Confirm the relaunch won't disrupt supply; See proof of consistent demand. Concerns: Cautious about more shelf space; Wants data, not just brand promises

One Brand, Radically Different Messages Per Segment

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Nike

Nike speaks to elite athletes through performance data and to everyday joggers through identity and self-belief — same brand, same logo, deliberately different message for each audience it serves.

Audience Mapping Workshop

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

Nimbus Wellness's 5th-anniversary relaunch has to speak to four very different audiences at once: existing loyal customers who feel the brand has drifted from them, new customers discovering Nimbus while comparing it to a competitor, the wellness retail chain deciding whether to expand shelf space, and the lifestyle press deciding whether the relaunch is even a story worth covering.

The Marketing Lead has one shared relaunch deck for all four groups. Your table's job is to show her, with evidence, why it cannot say the same thing to all four the same way — and what should change for each.

You'll produce: An audience mapping matrix (4 segments) with a tailored key message and primary channel for each

Duration: 25 minutes

Audience Mapping Workshop

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

What does each of the four audience segments actually need to hear to act — not just what Nimbus wants to say?

2

Where do B2C emotional drivers and B2B/partner logic-driven drivers pull the message in different directions?

3

Which channel does each segment genuinely pay attention to, and does the current "one deck" plan reach it?

4

If you only had budget to fully tailor one segment's message this month, which would you choose — and why?

Audience Mapping Workshop

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Which audience did your table initially lump together with another — and what made you split them apart?
- Was a channel choice driven by what's easy for Nimbus to produce, or by where the audience actually spends attention?
- How would your messaging change if the lifestyle press turned out to be sceptical rather than curious about the relaunch?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a matrix with a tailored key message and a named primary channel for all four segments, and can explain in one sentence why each message differs from the others.

LO1 · LU1 · T3

Draft branding designs and ideas highlighting the product or service's attributes and benefits

What is Draft branding designs and ideas highlighting the product or service's attributes and benefits?

1

Brand Strategy

Defines the unique selling proposition

2

Visual Identity

Builds a recognisable design system

3

Value Communication

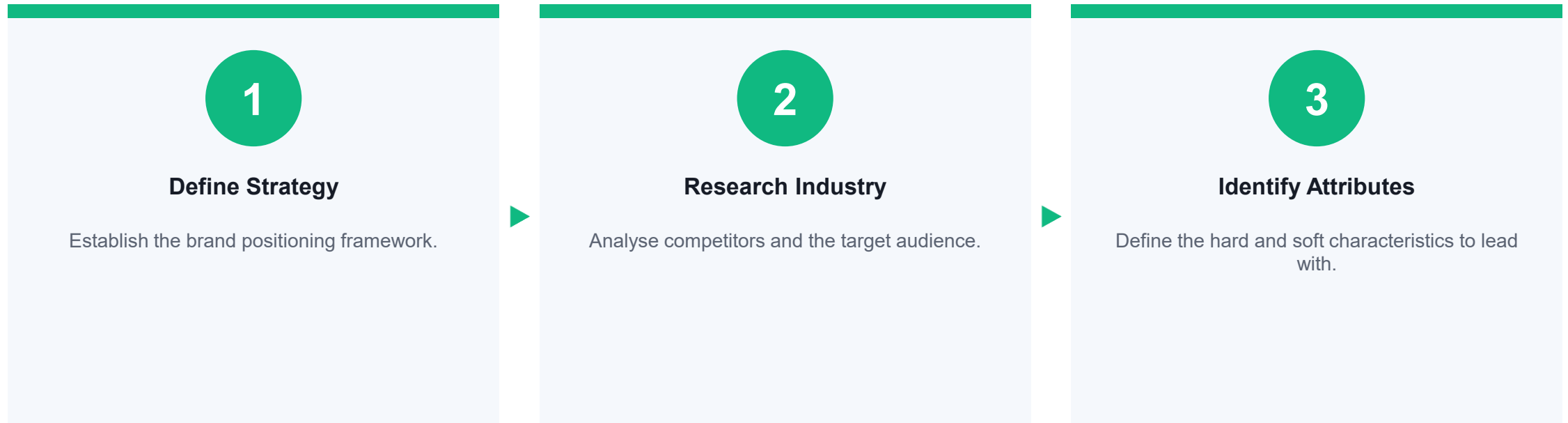
Translates features into benefits

4

Consistency

One brand experience, every touchpoint

Systematic Brand Development Process



Hard vs Soft Brand Attributes

Hard Attributes — Features

- Performance — quantifiable product capabilities
- Features — specific functional elements
- Quality — measurable build/ingredient standards

Soft Attributes — Feelings

- Prestige — perceived status and craft
- Trust — reliability and confidence
- Belonging — the feeling of being genuinely known

Keller's Customer-Based Brand Equity Pyramid

1

Salience — Identity

Is the brand noticed, and easily recalled, at all?

2

Performance & Imagery — Meaning

What the product does, and the lifestyle it signals.

3

Judgments & Feelings — Response

The customer's rational verdict and emotional reaction.

4

Resonance — Relationships

Deep loyalty — the customer becomes an active advocate.

Source: Keller, K.L. — Customer-Based Brand Equity (CBBE) Model, Strategic Brand Management

Hard Specs Sold as a Soft Feeling

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Apple

"Designed by Apple in California" turns a hard attribute (where it's engineered) into a soft one (craft, care, exclusivity) — the same discipline Nimbus needs to turn "3 clinically-tested actives" into "your skin, genuinely cared for."

Brand Attribute Mapping

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

For the relaunch, the founder wants one page that finally settles what Nimbus stands for — because right now the brand isn't described the same way twice. Retail calls it "affordable self-care." Marketing calls it "clean beauty for real skin." Customer Service calls it "the brand that actually replies."

Your table must map Nimbus's hard attributes (the real product facts) and soft attributes (the feelings those facts create) into one brand concept the founder can approve — and that all three teams could say in their own words.

You'll produce: A brand attribute map (3 hard + 3 soft attributes) linked to one approved brand concept line

Duration: 30 minutes

Brand Attribute Mapping

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

What are three hard attributes (measurable facts) Nimbus can genuinely claim about its skincare range?

2

What soft attribute — the feeling — does each hard attribute actually create, and is it the same feeling Retail, Marketing and Customer Service currently describe?

3

Using Keller's Brand Equity Pyramid, which level is Nimbus weakest at right now: being noticed (Salience), understood (Performance/Imagery), felt (Judgments/Feelings), or trusted enough to be recommended (Resonance)?

4

What single brand concept line could the founder approve that all three teams could restate consistently?

Brand Attribute Mapping

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Was it harder for your table to agree on the hard attributes or the soft attributes — and why?
- Which pyramid level did your table disagree about the most?
- If a customer only ever experienced Nimbus through a five-minute Customer Service chat, which attribute would that conversation need to prove true?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show 3 hard + 3 soft attributes connected to one brand concept line, and can name the CBBE pyramid level the concept is designed to strengthen.

LO1 · LU1 · T4

Assess organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms

What is Assess organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms?

1

Brand Monitoring

Tracks mentions across digital platforms

2

Sentiment Analysis

Reads the tone behind customer feedback

3

Multi-Platform

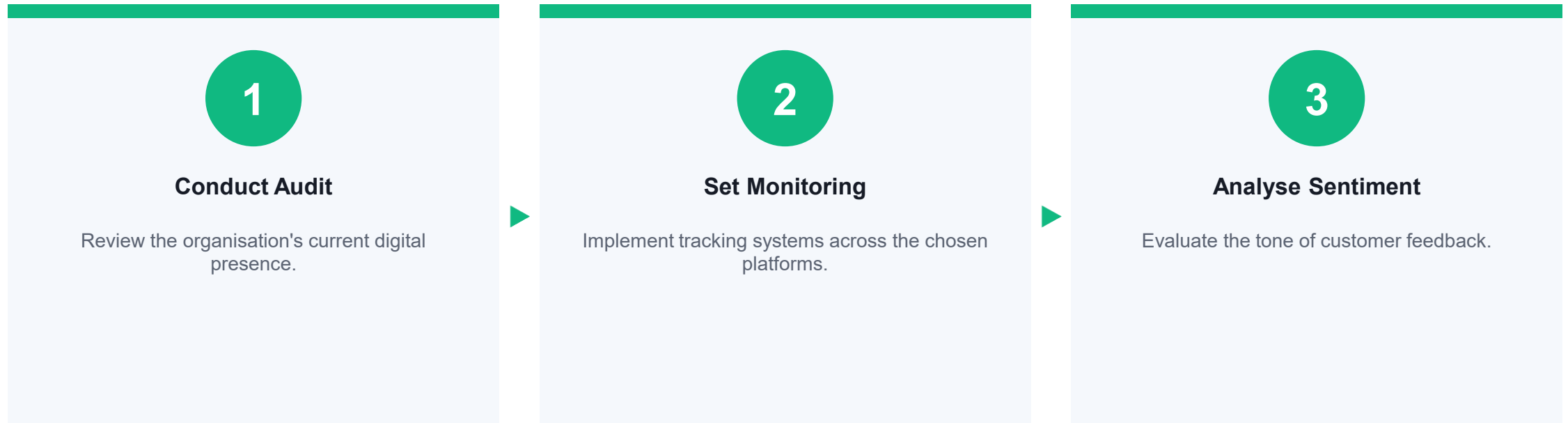
Covers every social and review site

4

Strategic Response

Turns findings into an action plan

Reputation Assessment Process Steps



Reactive vs Proactive Reputation Monitoring

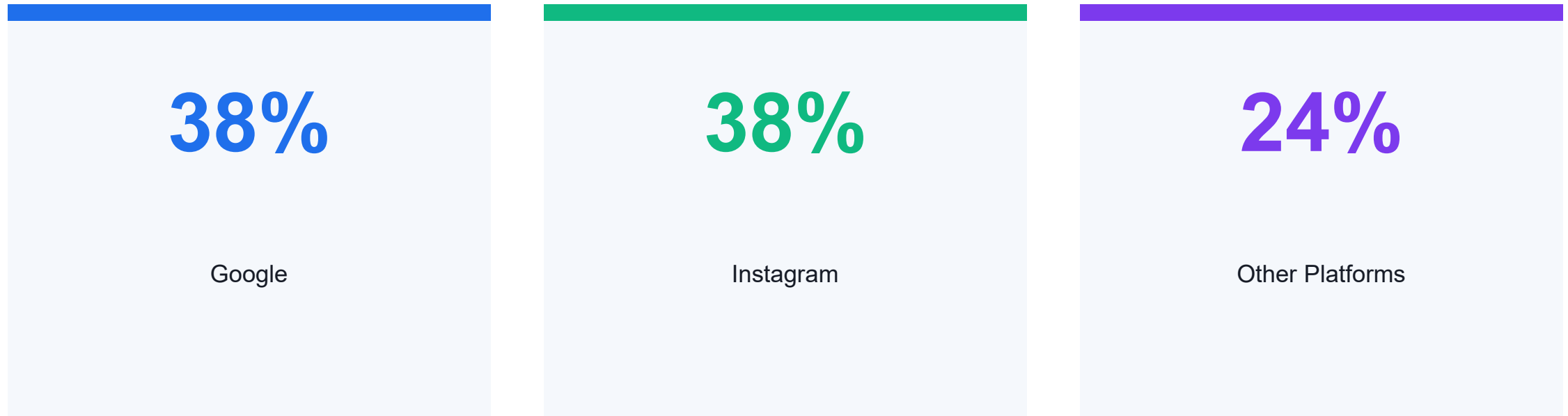
Reactive

- Damage Control — Crisis-response focus, after the fact
- Post-Issue — Action only once problems occur
- High Risk — Damage is already visible

Proactive

- Prevention Focus — Early issue identification
- Continuous Tracking — Ongoing brand monitoring
- Risk Mitigation — Caught before it spreads

Platform Distribution Statistics



Source: illustrative distribution, digital reputation audits

Reviews Are the Reputation, Not Just a Reflection of It

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Airbnb

Airbnb's entire trust model runs on visible, unfiltered reviews — hosts who monitor and respond fast build measurably higher booking rates than hosts who only check in when something goes wrong.

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

Six months ago a competitor's viral campaign pulled attention away from Nimbus Wellness. Since then, engagement has fallen and reviews increasingly say the brand "doesn't feel personal anymore."

Before the founder finalises the relaunch brief, leadership wants a clear-eyed audit of where Nimbus's reputation actually stands today — not where the founder assumes it stands.

You'll produce: A reputation-assessment report (3 platforms) with sentiment breakdown and a response action per theme

Duration: 45 minutes

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Which three platforms will actually reveal how customers feel about Nimbus right now — and why those three?

2

Looking at a sample of recent mentions and reviews, what recurring themes sit behind "doesn't feel personal anymore"?

3

How would you categorise the balance of positive, neutral and negative sentiment — and does it match what the founder currently believes?

4

What is the single highest-priority response action leadership should take before the relaunch brief is finalised?

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did the sentiment split match what you expected before you actually read the reviews?
- Which recurring theme was hardest to reduce to one line for a leadership summary?
- If "doesn't feel personal anymore" kept appearing after the relaunch too, what would that tell you about the relaunch plan itself?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a platform-by-platform sentiment breakdown, three named recurring themes, and one response action per theme leadership could act on this week.

Recap — Stakeholders and Organisation

1

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

You can now: Identify internal and external stakeholders influencing the brand.

2

Audience Mapping Workshop

You can now: Recognise the types of external audience and their needs.

3

Brand Attribute Mapping

You can now: Draft branding designs and ideas highlighting the product or service's attributes and benefits.

4

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

You can now: Assess the organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms.

LU1 · WHY IT MATTERS

A brand that hasn't mapped its stakeholders is still being defined by them.

— Closing thought, LU1: Stakeholders and Organisation

LU2

Customer Influence

Customer Perceptions · Brand Reputation · Campaign Reception · Active Listening

Key Concepts — Customer Influence

1

Customers form perceptions of a brand, its products and its services from quality, experience and communication — a gap often exists between what a company believes and what customers actually feel.

2

Customers actively shape brand reputation through word-of-mouth, reviews and advocacy — their voice can amplify or damage a brand faster than any paid campaign.

3

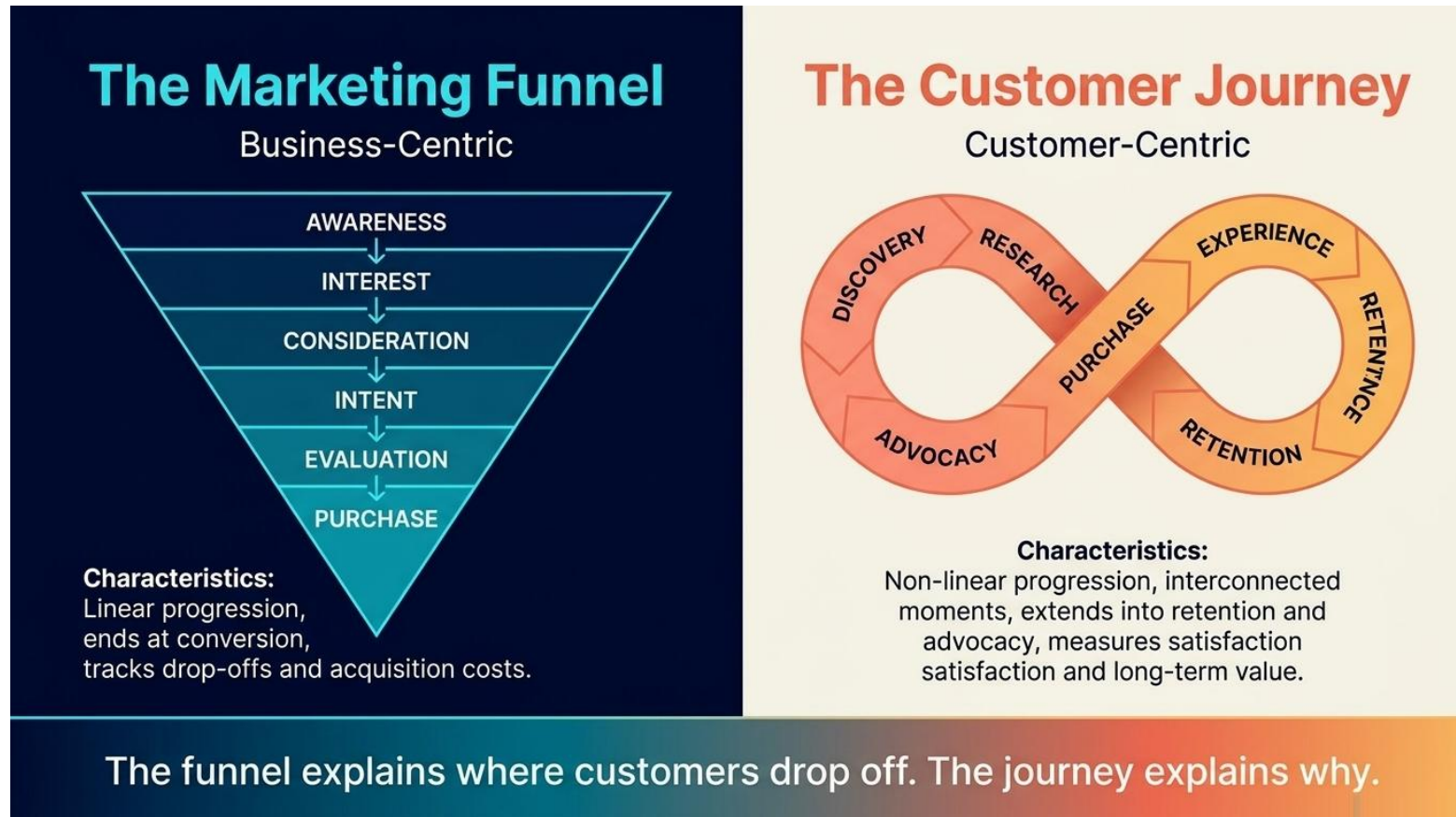
Documenting customer reception and the outcome of branding campaigns turns anecdotal feedback into evidence for future campaign decisions.

4

Active listening — full attention, a structured framework, and paraphrasing without judgement — reveals the customer's true perspective of the organisation.

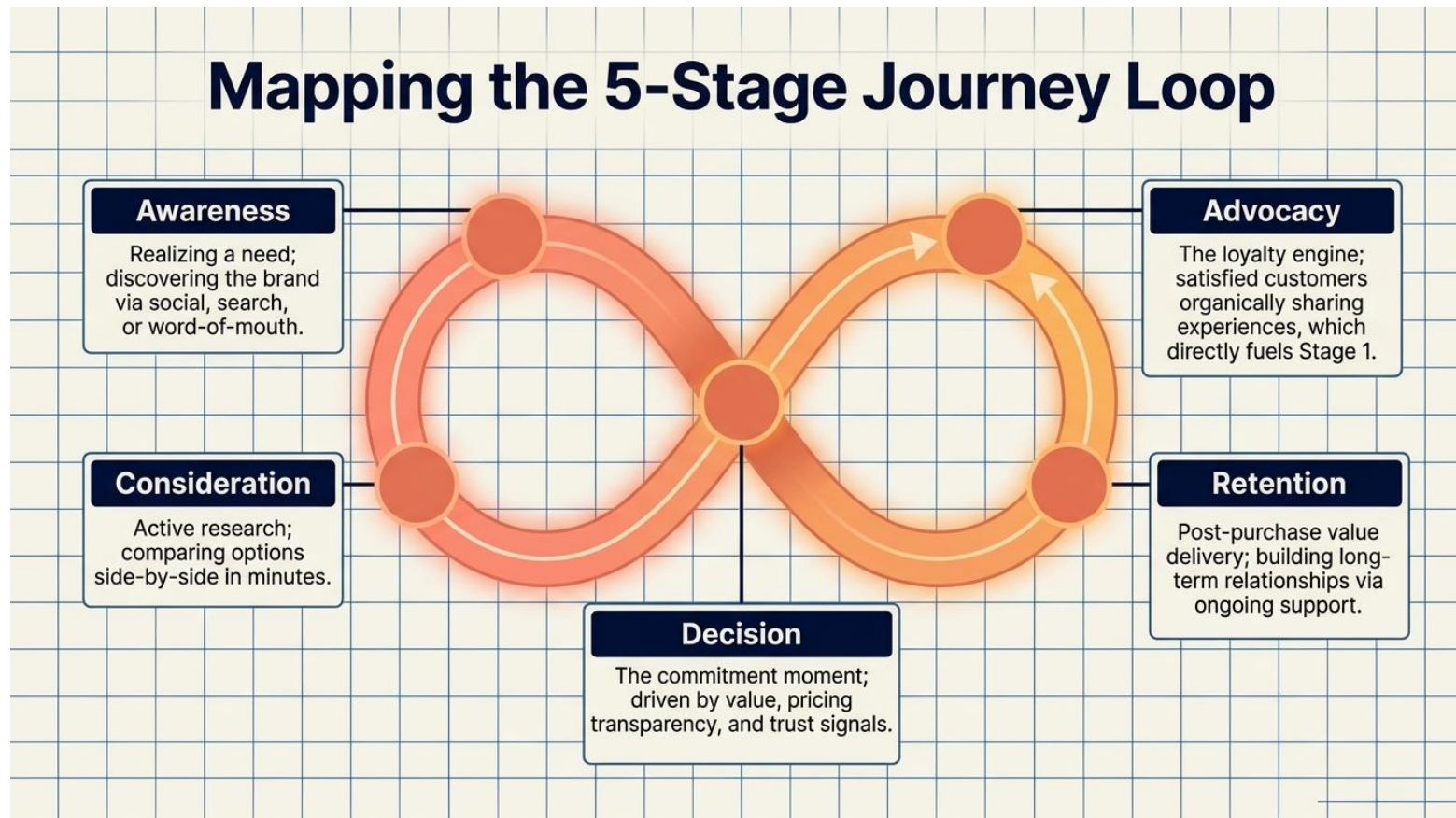
The Marketing Funnel vs the Customer Journey

The funnel explains where customers drop off; the journey explains why.



Mapping the 5-Stage Journey Loop

Awareness → Consideration → Decision → Retention → Advocacy — and advocacy feeds awareness again.



The Engine of Loyalty: Emotional Branding

Affect-driven purchasing decisions outpace purely rational choices.

45.2%

say an emotional connection with a brand is very important

42%

associate their favourite brands with trust & reliability

88.1%

actively choose branded products over non-branded alternatives

55% of loyalty is driven by quality — but 32% is driven entirely by customer service and emotional support.

LO2 · LU2 · T1

Perceptions of customers of the brand, products and services

What is Perceptions of customers of the brand, products and services?

1

Product View

Customer verdict on product quality

2

Brand Identity

Customer grasp of core brand values

3

Service Quality

Perceived value of every interaction

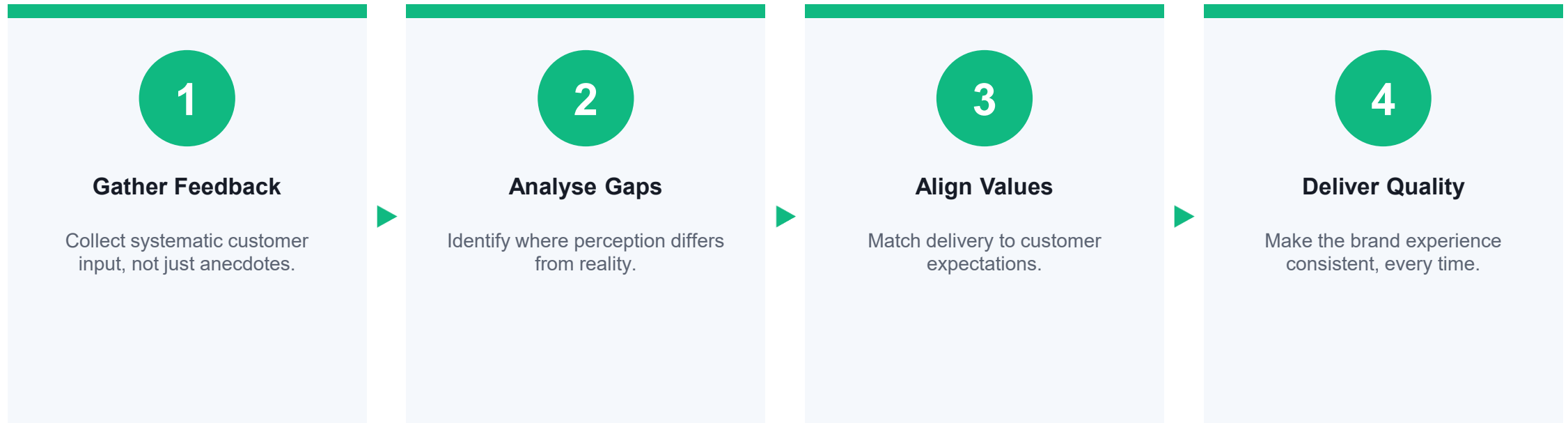
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Perception Gap

Gap between belief and reality

Source: Qualtrics, 2024

Perception Management Process



Technical Quality vs Value Quality

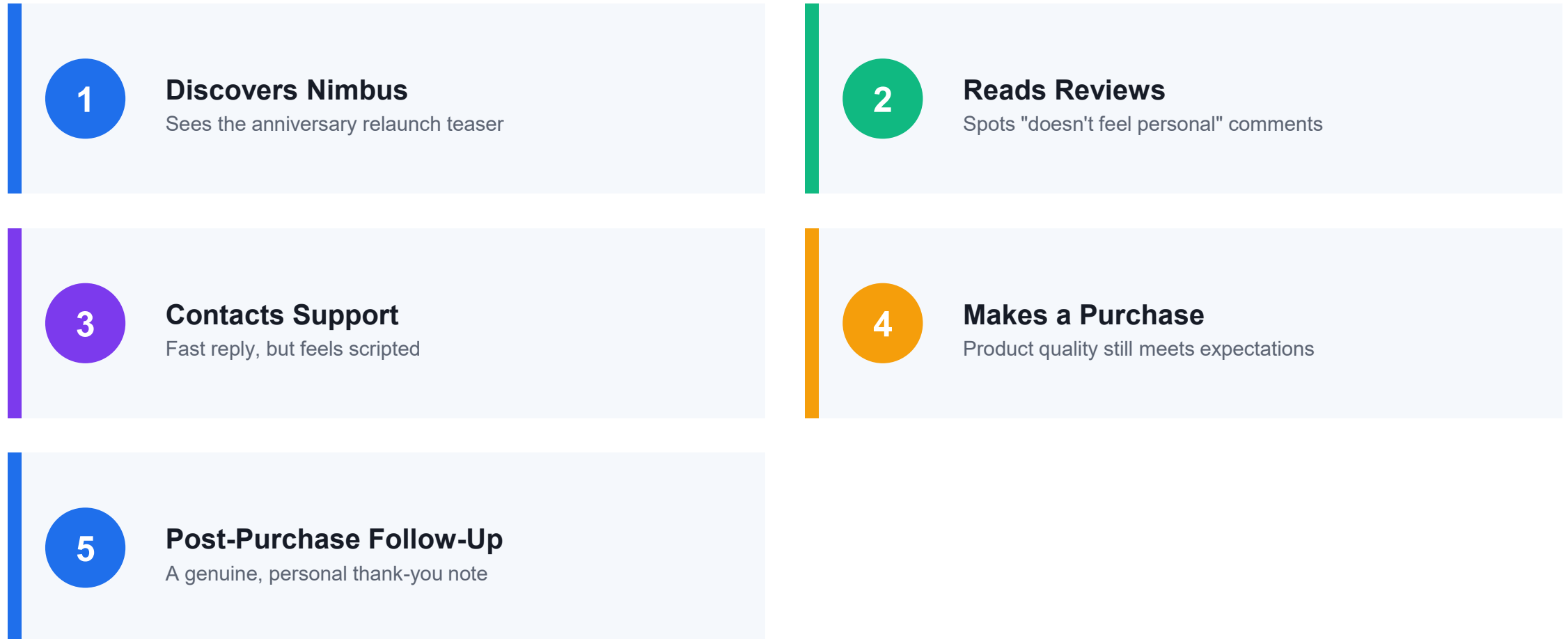
Technical Quality

- Specifications — what the product objectively does
- Performance — how reliably it does it
- Reliability — consistency over time

Value Quality

- Brand Image — how the brand is perceived
- Perception — the customer's subjective read
- Experience — how it feels to interact with the brand

The Nimbus Perception Gap Journey



Radical Customer Focus Closes the Perception Gap

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Zappos

Zappos reps have no call-time targets and no scripts — one legendary call ran past ten hours because the goal was connection, not resolution. That is the instinct Nimbus's faster-but-generic chat macros are quietly losing: speed without warmth is still a gap.

Brand Perception Audit

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

The Activity 4 reputation audit surfaced one theme again and again: customers say Nimbus Wellness "doesn't feel personal anymore." Marketing's official position is that nothing has changed — the formulas, ingredients and packaging are exactly what they were a year ago. If the product itself hasn't moved, something else has.

A closer look at Customer Service's own numbers hints at where: average reply time has improved since two outlets added self-checkout kiosks and the contact-centre adopted faster chat macros. The technical quality — what the product does — looks unchanged on paper. But the value quality — how it feels to deal with Nimbus — may have quietly slipped underneath the metrics leadership actually tracks.

Before the founder locks the relaunch brief, your table must compare what Marketing believes against what a sample of real customer feedback actually says, and turn the difference into a short, prioritised gap list leadership can act on this week.

You'll produce: A Nimbus perception-gap analysis comparing internal quality metrics with customer feedback, ranking the top 3 gaps with an action for each

Duration: 25 minutes

Brand Perception Audit

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Looking at the Activity 4 findings alongside what Marketing believes internally, where exactly does customer perception diverge from the company's own view of itself?

2

Is the drift really in Technical Quality (the product itself) or in Value Quality (the experience around it) — and what evidence from the audit supports that?

3

What are the top 3 perception gaps your table would put in front of the founder, and which one is most urgent to close before the relaunch brief is finalised?

4

For each gap, what would "closed" actually look like, and which team would need to own fixing it?

Brand Perception Audit

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your table's top gap turn out to be about the product itself, or about how people are treated when they interact with the brand?
- Was there a gap the data supported that still felt uncomfortable to put in front of the founder — and why?
- If Marketing pushed back and insisted the product is the whole story, what evidence would you point to first?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a gap-analysis table comparing Marketing's internal belief against real customer feedback, with the top 3 perception gaps ranked and one concrete action proposed for each.

LO2 · LU2 · T2

Importance of the customer in influencing the brand reputation

What is Importance of the customer in influencing the brand reputation?

1

Trust Factor

Personal recommendations drive purchase decisions

2

Viral Spread

Positive experiences multiply through networks

3

Digital Voice

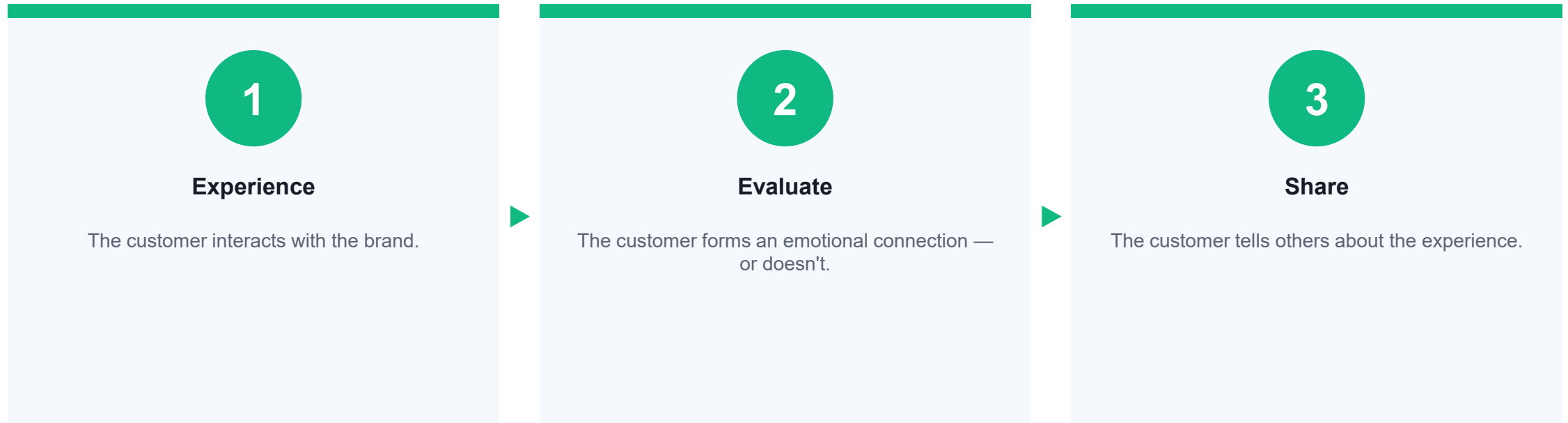
Online reviews equal family recommendations

4

Reputation Control

Customers actively shape the brand image

Customer Advocacy Process



Positive vs Negative Word-of-Mouth Impact

Positive Experience

- Recommendation — 36% recommend within two weeks
- Emotional Bond — 3x more word-of-mouth generated
- Trust Building — builds lasting brand loyalty

Negative Experience

- Share Bad — 45% share negative experiences
- Brand Avoidance — 26% completely avoid the brand
- Reputation Damage — long-term perception harm

The Advocacy Loop

1

Experience

A genuine, well-handled touchpoint with Nimbus — in store, online or on a call.

2

Satisfaction

The customer's private verdict on that touchpoint, good or bad.

3

Word-of-Mouth

A satisfied customer voluntarily tells others — a post, a tag, a conversation.

4

New-Customer Discovery

A prospect meets Nimbus through that story, restarting the loop.

Source: customer advocacy loop, adapted from WebFX / Digital Silk 2024

Owners, Not Ads, Built the Tesla Brand

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Tesla

Tesla spends close to nothing on traditional advertising — owners self-organise meetups, share referral codes and post their own reviews instead. Nimbus's loyal Facebook community is the same asset already in hand, waiting to be invested in rather than replaced by paid media.

Brand Advocacy Assessment

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

Activity 5 traced the perception gap mostly to Value Quality — the feeling of being known — rather than to the product itself. That is, in one sense, good news: it means Nimbus already has the raw material to fix it. The same loyal-customer Facebook community that has been asking "why hasn't Nimbus gone green sooner?" is still active, still buying, and still willing to talk about the brand.

The founder now wants the relaunch to lean on these genuine advocates rather than paid media alone. But the online review picture is mixed — some customers are clearly still delighted, others are the ones driving the "doesn't feel personal anymore" narrative, and a few are firmly on the fence.

Your table's job is to read the available feedback, identify who the real advocates are, and design an advocacy assessment and strategy that strengthens the loop before the anniversary campaign goes live — without ignoring the risk that a negative experience could restart the narrative that hurt Nimbus six months ago.

You'll produce: A customer-advocacy strategy mapped to the Advocacy Loop, with named target metrics and how each will be tracked

Duration: 25 minutes

Brand Advocacy Assessment

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Reading the mixed feedback, which customers are the strongest genuine candidates for an advocacy programme, and what evidence marks them out from a merely satisfied customer?

2

Using the Advocacy Loop, at which stage is Nimbus currently strongest, and at which stage does the loop most often break down before it reaches a new customer?

3

Given that a competitor's viral moment is what hurt Nimbus six months ago, how real is the risk that one bad experience among these advocates could restart the same narrative — and how would you guard against it?

4

What would you actually ask advocates to do for the relaunch, and what would Nimbus need to give them in return for it to feel genuine rather than transactional?

Brand Advocacy Assessment

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your table pick advocates based on how loudly they post, or on how consistently satisfied they actually are?
- Which stage of the Advocacy Loop did your table find hardest to strengthen with the resources Nimbus realistically has?
- If one of your chosen advocates had a bad experience next week, would your strategy survive it?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show an advocacy strategy mapped onto the Advocacy Loop, naming which customers to engage, what stage of the loop it strengthens, and at least one target metric with how it will be tracked.

LO2 · LU2 · T3

Document customer reception to brand and outcome of branding campaigns

What is Document customer reception to brand and outcome of branding campaigns?

1

Feedback Collection

Systematic recording of customer responses

2

Campaign Metrics

Measuring effectiveness through customer data

3

Analysis Systems

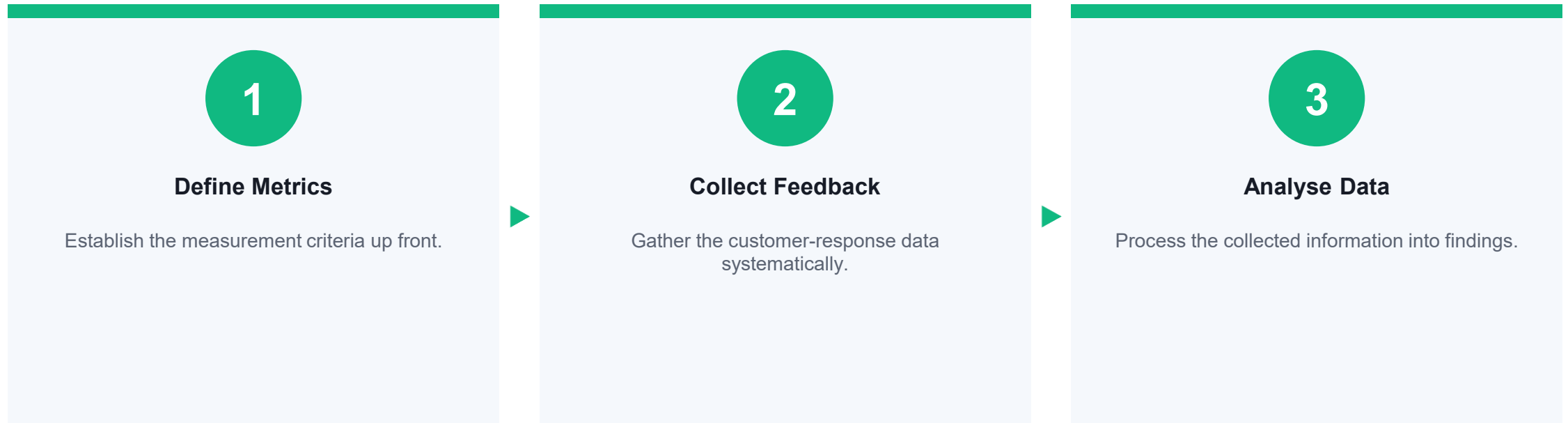
Documentation frameworks for brand reception

4

Outcome Tracking

Recording measurable campaign results

Documentation Process Steps



Traditional vs Modern Documentation Approaches

Traditional

- Manual Surveys — paper-based feedback collection
- Basic Analytics — simple metrics and reporting
- Delayed Insights — weekly or monthly reporting cycles

Modern

- Real-Time Monitoring — instant sentiment tracking
- AI Insights — automated pattern recognition
- Predictive Analytics — trend forecasting capability

The PESO Model

1

Paid Media

Boosted posts and sponsored placements Nimbus paid to run.

2

Earned Media

Unprompted press coverage and mentions Nimbus didn't pay for.

3

Shared Media

Reposts, tags and comments the community generated on its own.

4

Owned Media

The blog post, email newsletter and product page Nimbus fully controls.

Source: PESO Model (Paid, Earned, Shared, Owned), Gini Dietrich / Spin Sucks

Every Test Gets Measured, Every Time

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Netflix

Netflix documents disciplined A/B tests down to thumbnail images and runs every creative change against hard viewership data — nothing ships on a hunch. That documentation discipline is exactly what Nimbus's pilot campaign lacked: a record consistent enough to trust before scaling it up.

Campaign Documentation Audit

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

Three months ago, before committing the full relaunch budget, the Marketing Lead quietly piloted a small "Behind the Jar" campaign — a short Instagram Stories series introducing the new sustainable-packaging story to a slice of the loyal-customer community, alongside one boosted post, a short unpaid write-up from a local lifestyle blog, and a supporting post on the Nimbus website.

Nobody kept a single, consistent record of how it performed. Some numbers live in a Marketing team member's spreadsheet, some in a Notion page nobody else can find, and the rest is only in people's memory of "it went pretty well." With the Board wanting proof that the full relaunch campaign works — not just louder impressions — that will not be good enough this time.

Your table's job is to reconstruct what actually happened to the pilot campaign across paid, earned, shared and owned media, and turn it into a documentation framework the team can reuse for the real relaunch three months from now.

You'll produce: A structured PESO-based campaign-reception report for the pilot, with metrics, gaps and a documentation framework the team can reuse for the full relaunch

Duration: 25 minutes

Campaign Documentation Audit

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Sorting the pilot's activity into Paid, Earned, Shared and Owned media, where did the strongest customer reception actually happen — and does that match where the team spent the most effort?

2

Which pieces of the pilot's story are you missing data for entirely, and how would you close that gap before the full relaunch campaign launches?

3

What documentation framework would you standardise now, so results don't have to be reconstructed from memory again after the real relaunch?

4

Based on the pilot's results, what is the strongest evidence you would put in front of the Board to justify the relaunch's PR budget?

Campaign Documentation Audit

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Which of the four PESO categories was hardest to find any real data for — and what does that tell you about Nimbus's current documentation habits?
- Did the channel that felt most successful in the room match the channel the numbers actually supported?
- If the Board asked "how do we know this worked?" right now, could your documentation answer them convincingly?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a PESO-sorted reception report for the pilot campaign with at least one metric per media type, the gaps in current data called out honestly, and a reusable documentation framework for the full relaunch.

LO2 · LU2 · T4

Perform active listening from customer to understand customer's perspective of the organisation

What is Perform active listening from customer to understand customer's perspective of the organisation?

1

Full Attention

Eliminate distractions during customer interactions

2

3 P's Framework

Presence, Patience, and Paraphrasing approach

3

Emotion Focus

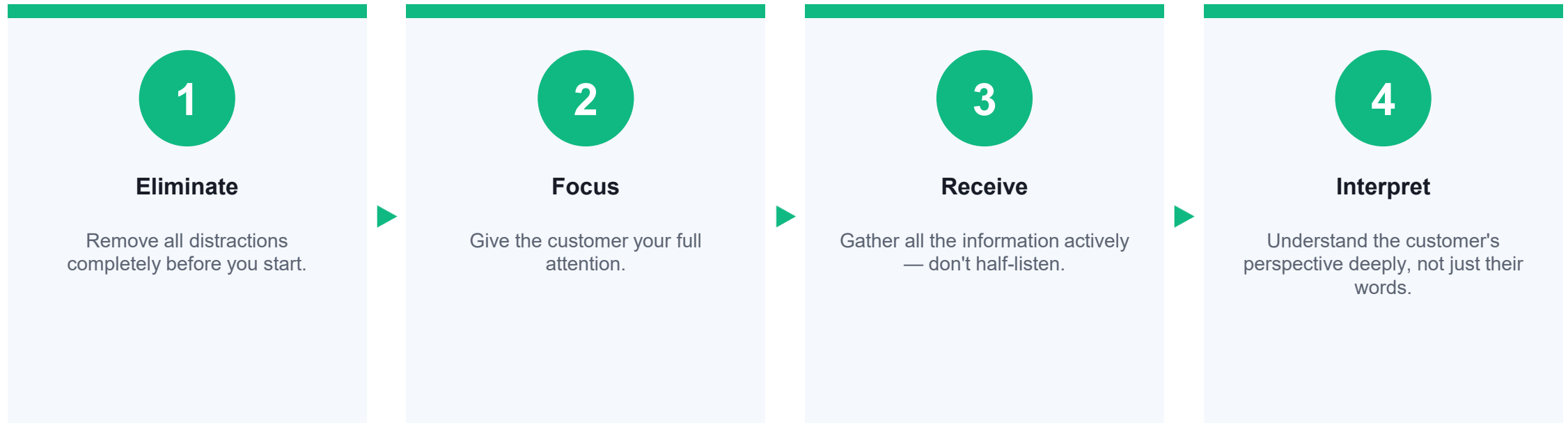
Understanding the feelings behind customer words

4

Strategic Insight

Gather valuable customer perception data

Active Listening Implementation Steps



Passive Hearing vs Active Listening

Passive Hearing

- Word Focus — Hearing only the literal words, missing the tone underneath them.
- Response Ready — Mentally drafting the scripted reply while the customer is still talking.
- Surface Level — Closing the call once the words stop, without checking the feeling behind them.

The 3 P's — Active Listening

- Presence — Full attention, phone and scripts aside — genuinely there for the call.
- Patience — Letting the customer finish completely before responding, without rushing.
- Paraphrasing — Reflecting the concern back in your own words to confirm you understood it.

Source: the 3 P's active-listening framework (Presence, Patience, Paraphrasing), customer-service training practice.

Customer Empathy Map — Priya

1

Says

"Why doesn't Nimbus feel personal anymore?"; "I've bought from you since year one."

2

Thinks

Does anyone here still actually care?; Maybe I'm just an order number now.

3

Does

Calls Customer Service instead of emailing.; Reads the community Facebook thread nightly.

4

Feels

Frustrated and quietly disappointed.; Still hopeful Nimbus can win her back.

The Empty Chair That Represents the Customer

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Amazon

Amazon famously keeps an empty chair in meetings to represent the customer whose voice isn't otherwise in the room — a physical reminder to listen before deciding. The 3 P's do the same work on a live call: they force Presence, Patience and Paraphrasing instead of assumption.

Customer Perspective Analysis

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

Priya has bought from Nimbus Wellness since its first year. Last night she read the same community Facebook thread the Activity 4 audit flagged — customers saying Nimbus "doesn't feel personal anymore" — and she agrees. This morning she calls Customer Service, frustrated, wanting to know why the brand she used to feel loyal to now treats her like any other order number.

The rep taking the call has a real average-handle-time target and a bank of quick-reply macros that would close this call in under two minutes. But leadership has asked every Customer Service call this week to be an active-listening opportunity, not just a resolution — because this exact situation is what the relaunch's active-listening approach will need to prove it can handle.

Your group of three will run this call as a role play, coached in real time against the 3 P's, then turn what was actually said — not just what was resolved — into a documented customer-perspective insight for the relaunch team.

You'll produce: A completed customer-perspective analysis report — the emotion behind the words, a coaching note against the 3 P's, and one actionable insight for the relaunch team

Duration: 25 minutes

Customer Perspective Analysis

ASSIGN THE ROLES

The Customer (Priya)

GOAL

Be heard and taken seriously, not just processed

A five-year loyal customer who feels increasingly like a transaction. She isn't asking for a refund — she wants to know if anyone at Nimbus still cares.

Nimbus Service Rep

GOAL

Resolve the call by genuinely listening, not by closing it fast

Under real pressure to keep the call short, but has been told this week that how the call feels matters as much as how quickly it ends.

Observer / Coach

GOAL

Apply the 3 P's framework as a coaching lens on the call

Says nothing during the role play itself, but tracks exactly where Presence, Patience and Paraphrasing show up — or don't — to coach the Rep afterwards.

Customer Perspective Analysis

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

As the call plays out, where does the Rep genuinely apply Presence, Patience and Paraphrasing — and where do they slip back into passive hearing?

2

What emotion is actually behind Priya's words, as distinct from the literal complaint she's making?

3

How would the Observer paraphrase Priya's perspective back in one honest sentence, without judgement and without minimising it?

4

Beyond "the customer was upset," what concrete, actionable insight should this call generate for the relaunch team?

Customer Perspective Analysis

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- As the Customer, at what point in the call did you feel genuinely heard — or feel yourself give up on being heard?
- As the Rep, was it harder to stay patient, or harder to paraphrase without sounding scripted?
- As the Observer, which of the 3 P's was missing most often, and what would you coach first?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a completed customer-perspective analysis that names the emotion behind Priya's words (not just the words themselves), cites a specific moment where a P was applied or missed, and closes with one actionable insight for the relaunch team.

Recap — Customer Influence

1

Brand Perception Audit

You can now: Assess customer perceptions of the brand, products and services.

2

Brand Advocacy Assessment

You can now: Recognise the importance of the customer in influencing brand reputation.

3

Campaign Documentation Audit

You can now: Document customer reception to the brand and the outcome of branding campaigns.

4

Customer Perspective Analysis

You can now: Perform active listening from the customer to understand the customer's perspective of the organisation.

LU2 · WHY IT MATTERS

The gap between what you believe about your brand and what customers feel is where reputations are won or lost.

— Closing thought, LU2: Customer Influence

LU3

Branding in Marketing

Branding Basics · Role in Marketing · Awareness Campaigns · PR Execution

Key Concepts — Branding in Marketing

1

Branding basics — visual identity, brand values, brand voice and brand guidelines — give a business a consistent, recognisable presence.

2

Branding plays a central role in marketing: it builds trust, differentiates from competitors and creates the emotional connection that drives loyalty.

3

Executing branding campaigns, events and activities — from social pushes to experiential pop-ups — raises brand awareness across the target audience.

4

Public-relations campaigns must align to the brand positioning strategy, the operational plan and the marketing budget to stay credible and sustainable.

The Anatomy of Brand Authenticity

Authenticity is engineered through four repeatable practices.

Radical Transparency

Open communication about business practices and product origins — e.g. Patagonia's Footprint Chronicles detailing supply-chain realities.

Value Alignment

Emotional connection forged through shared beliefs and societal commitment — e.g. Ben & Jerry's integration of social justice into core operations.

Authentic Storytelling

Humanising the brand through relatable, non-fabricated narratives — e.g. Nike highlighting genuine struggles and triumphs of real athletes.

Quality Assurance

Trust earned through unwavering consistency and reliability — e.g. Toyota's rigorous quality control building global dependability.

The Trust Fracture: the Say-Do Gap

How trust fractures

- Brand authenticity is destroyed by inauthentic practices — when a company's actions contradict its stated promises.
- Discrepancies between marketing claims and operational reality create a trust fracture that severs the customer journey loop permanently.
- PR campaigns can only amplify what operations can prove.

Case: the Volkswagen emissions scandal

- Software was installed to cheat emissions tests.
- The deception directly contradicted public claims of environmental responsibility.
- Result: immediate, catastrophic loss of consumer trust — a say-do gap no campaign could repair.

LO3 · LU3 · T1

Basics in branding

What is Basics in branding?

1

Visual Identity

Logo, colours and typography, defined once

2

Brand Values

The mission every decision should reflect

3

Brand Voice

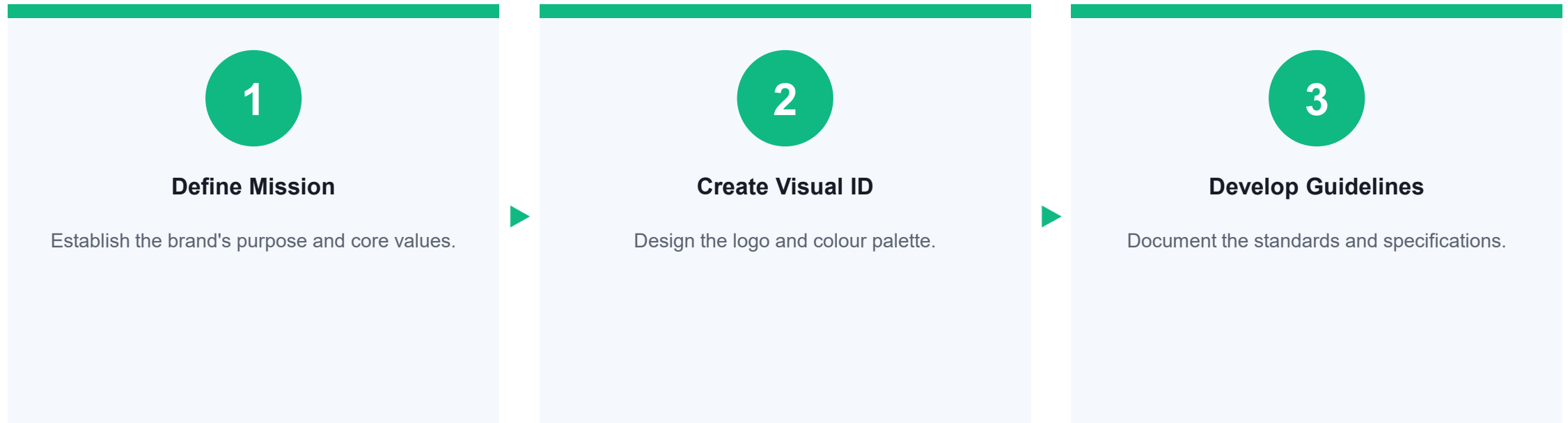
One tone, consistently written

4

Brand Guidelines

The standard every team applies

Brand Development Process



Consistent vs Inconsistent Branding

Consistent Brand

- Revenue Boost — measurably higher financial performance
- Recognition — a single colour/voice system customers recall
- Trust Building — stronger consumer confidence

Inconsistent Brand

- Lower Trust — reduced consumer confidence
- Weak Recognition — confused brand identity across teams
- Market Confusion — unclear value proposition

Brand Guidelines System

1

Visual Identity

The logo, colour palette and typography every touchpoint must use.

2

Brand Values

The mission and principles the brand concept line is built on.

3

Brand Voice

The tone — friendly, expert, warm — every team writes in.

4

Usage Guidelines

Concrete do's and don'ts so the standard survives contact with real work.

One Guidelines System, 60+ Markets, Zero Guesswork

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

IKEA

IKEA's showroom logic, product naming and flat-pack identity read as unmistakably IKEA whether you're in Singapore or Stockholm — proof a written standard, not local instinct, is what keeps a brand recognisable at scale. It's exactly the gap Nimbus's differing Retail, Marketing and Customer Service descriptions expose today.

Brand Audit Workshop

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

Nimbus Wellness now has an approved brand concept line from the LU1 attribute-mapping work — but the founder has noticed that the website, the in-store signage and the Instagram bio still each describe the brand slightly differently. Nothing has actually been written down as a standard.

With the 5th-anniversary relaunch three months away, the founder wants one brand-guidelines document that Retail, Marketing and Customer Service can all point to — before a single relaunch asset (banner, caption, staff script) gets produced.

Your table has been asked to draft that guidelines document from the brand concept line Nimbus already approved.

You'll produce: A brand-guidelines document — visual standards, voice guidelines and an implementation roadmap

Duration: 30 minutes

Brand Audit Workshop

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Starting from Nimbus's approved brand concept line, what visual-identity specifications (logo usage, colour palette, typography) actually protect that concept?

2

What brand values and mission statement belong in the guidelines so all three teams can restate them the same way?

3

What does "Nimbus's voice" sound like in a customer email versus an Instagram caption — where should the tone flex, and where must it stay fixed?

4

What is one concrete usage example (a do/don't pair) that would stop the inconsistency the founder has already noticed?

Brand Audit Workshop

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Which building block — visual identity, values, voice or usage rules — was hardest for your table to pin down in concrete terms?
- Did your voice guideline actually sound different from a generic "friendly and professional" brand, or could it apply to any wellness company?
- If a new hire in Customer Service only ever read your guidelines document, would they write in Nimbus's voice by the end of week one?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a one-page brand-guidelines draft — visual identity spec, brand values, a voice description with an example, and at least one concrete usage do/don't — that Retail, Marketing and Customer Service could each apply without further clarification.

LO3 · LU3 · T2

Role of branding in marketing

What is Role of branding in marketing?

1

Brand Identity

A unique, recognisable set of values

2

Trust Building

Confidence that compounds over time

3

Differentiation

A clear stand-out from competitors

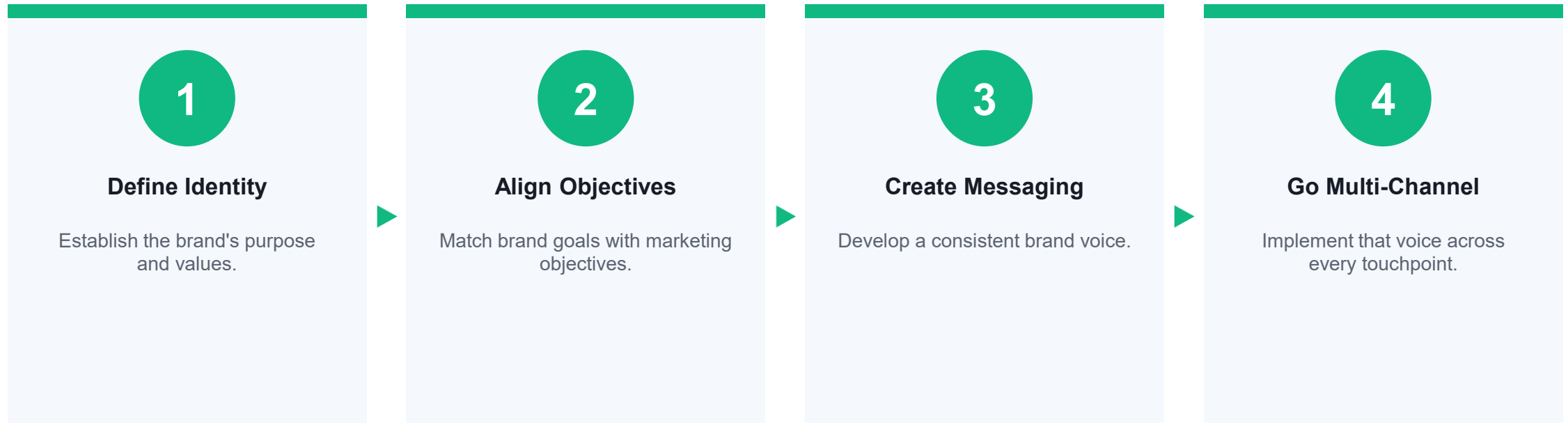
4

Emotional Connection

A relationship, not just a purchase

Source: brand marketing practice synthesis

Brand-Marketing Integration Process



Traditional Marketing vs Brand Marketing

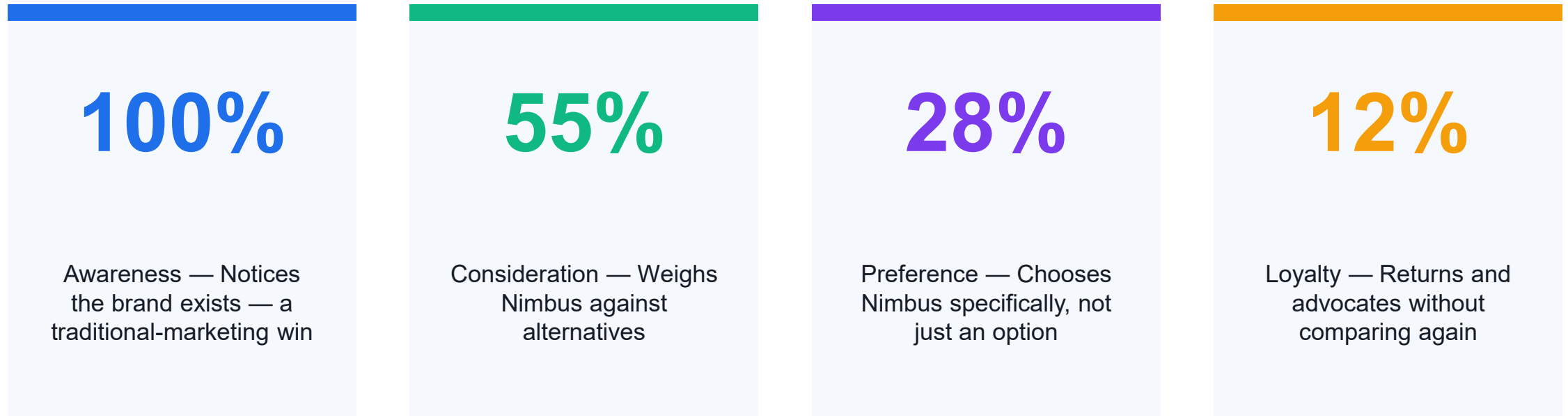
Traditional Marketing

- Product Focus — sells features
- Short-term — campaign by campaign
- Transactional — one purchase at a time

Brand Marketing

- Identity Focus — sells what the brand stands for
- Long-term — builds equity over years
- Emotional — builds a relationship with the customer

From Transactional Funnel to Brand Loyalty



Source: illustrative narrowing, brand-marketing funnel synthesis

One Theme-Park Trip, a Lifetime of Loyalty

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Disney

Disney never markets a single visit — every touchpoint is built to turn one trip into decades of return visits, merchandise and generational loyalty. It's the Brand Marketing column in action: identity and emotion compounding, not a transaction closed and forgotten.

Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

The Marketing Lead has just shown your table Nimbus's most recent campaign: a two-week discount push on the best-selling serum, promoted purely on price. It performed well on sales, but the founder is uneasy — it never once mentioned the brand values from the LU1 attribute map, and a few loyal customers commented that it "felt like any other skincare sale."

Before the relaunch campaign is greenlit, leadership wants proof that Nimbus's marketing activity is actually building the brand, not just borrowing short-term attention from it. Your table has been asked to audit the discount campaign against Nimbus's approved brand identity.

You'll produce: A brand-audit report with a consistency assessment and recommendations

Duration: 20 minutes

Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Which core identity elements from Nimbus's approved brand concept should this campaign have reflected — and which of them actually appeared in the discount push?

2

Was the discount campaign's messaging aligned with the brand's identity, or did it lean on price alone the way a generic competitor would?

3

Where exactly is the gap between what the campaign said and what the brand stands for — and how wide is it?

4

What two or three concrete changes would make the next relaunch-adjacent campaign build brand equity instead of just moving stock?

Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your table's consistency score match what the loyal-customer comments already hinted at?
- Was the gap you found about the message itself, or about which channel carried it?
- If every future Nimbus campaign scored this low on brand alignment, what would that do to the 5th-anniversary relaunch's credibility?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a brand-audit report with a consistency assessment score for the discount campaign, the specific identity elements that were missing, and two or three concrete recommendations for better brand-marketing integration.

LO3 · LU3 · T3

Execute branding campaigns, events and activities to increase brand awareness

What is Execute branding campaigns, events and activities to increase brand awareness?

1

Campaign Planning

A multi-channel strategy, built before launch

2

Event Activation

An experiential, interactive brand moment

3

Channel Coordination

One consistent message across platforms

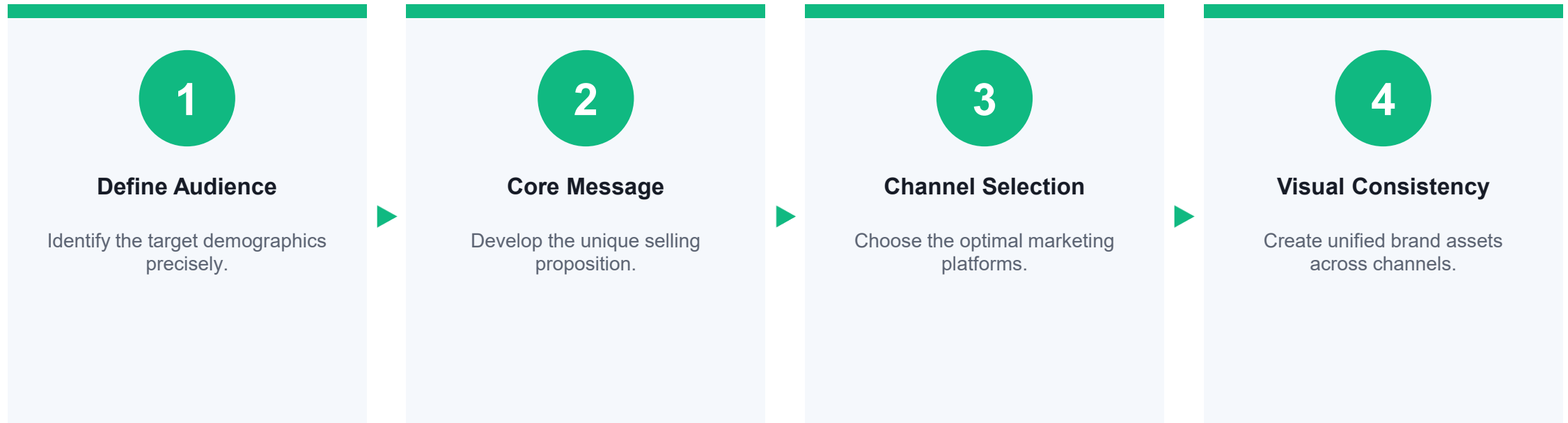
4

Performance Measurement

Brand recall and recognition tracked

Source: experiential-marketing / brand-activation practice, Singapore 2025

Campaign Execution Process



Traditional Campaign vs Experiential Activation

Traditional

- Print & Press Ads — One-way placements in newspapers and lifestyle magazines
- Radio Spots — Audio commercial broadcasts with no direct interaction
- Digital Banner Ads — Passive display advertising customers scroll past

Experiential

- Interactive Pop-Up — A gamified, multi-sensory space customers step into and explore
- Live Brand Event — A hands-on activation built around the anniversary story
- UGC-Ready Moments — Social-share-ready touchpoints designed for guests to post themselves

Source: experiential-marketing / brand-activation practice, Singapore 2025

Relaunch Pop-Up — Illustrative Activation KPIs

+42%

Pop-Up Foot Traffic —
vs an average retail
week

1,850

Social Mentions —
UGC-tagged posts,
launch week

18%

Sample-to-Purchase —
Conversion rate at the
pop-up

31%

Follow-Up Email Opens
— vs a 22% baseline
average

Source: illustrative values, brand-activation KPI benchmarks

A Seasonal Cup Turns One Visit Into a Shareable Moment

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Starbucks

Starbucks's seasonal pop-up drinks and store experiences aren't really about the product — they're multi-sensory moments customers queue for, photograph and post themselves. It's the same experiential principle behind Nimbus's relaunch pop-up: give people something to walk into, not just an ad to scroll past.

Brand Activation Planning Workshop

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

The brand guidelines are drafted and the consistency gaps are named. Now the founder needs an actual activation plan for the 5th-anniversary relaunch — the campaign that has to win back the customers who say Nimbus "doesn't feel personal anymore" while reaching new customers who are comparing Nimbus to the competitor whose viral campaign started this six months ago.

The founder has one non-negotiable: the relaunch needs at least one experiential element, not just another round of social ads — something people can walk into, touch or take part in, and want to share themselves.

Your table's job is to design the channel mix, the core message and that one experiential element, all traceable back to the brand concept and voice Nimbus has already approved.

You'll produce: A campaign-strategy document with timeline, budget allocation and success metrics

Duration: 30 minutes

Brand Activation Planning Workshop

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

What is the one core message the relaunch campaign should carry everywhere — and how does it answer the "doesn't feel personal anymore" perception gap directly?

2

Which 3-4 channels (owned, earned, paid) should carry that message, and what does each channel need to do differently to stay true to Nimbus's brand voice?

3

What is your one experiential element, and what makes it relevant, emotionally engaging and genuinely shareable rather than just an expensive photo backdrop?

4

How will you know the activation actually built brand recall, not just short-term foot traffic or impressions?

Brand Activation Planning Workshop

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your experiential idea start from the brand story, or did the brand story get bolted on afterward to justify an idea your table already liked?
- Which channel in your mix was hardest to keep consistent with Nimbus's brand voice, and why?
- If the experiential element only reached 200 people in person, what would have to be true about the rest of your channel mix for the relaunch to still feel successful?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a campaign plan naming 3-4 channels, one core message traceable to the brand concept, one experiential element with a clear rationale, and a brand-recall metric for measuring success — not just a reach or attendance number.

 LO3 · LU3 · T4

Execute public relations campaigns in alignment to brand positioning strategies, operational plans and budget

What is Execute public relations campaigns in alignment to brand positioning strategies, operational plans and budget?

1

Brand Positioning

The foundation every PR message builds on

2

Operational Plans

A structured plan for campaign delivery

3

Budget Management

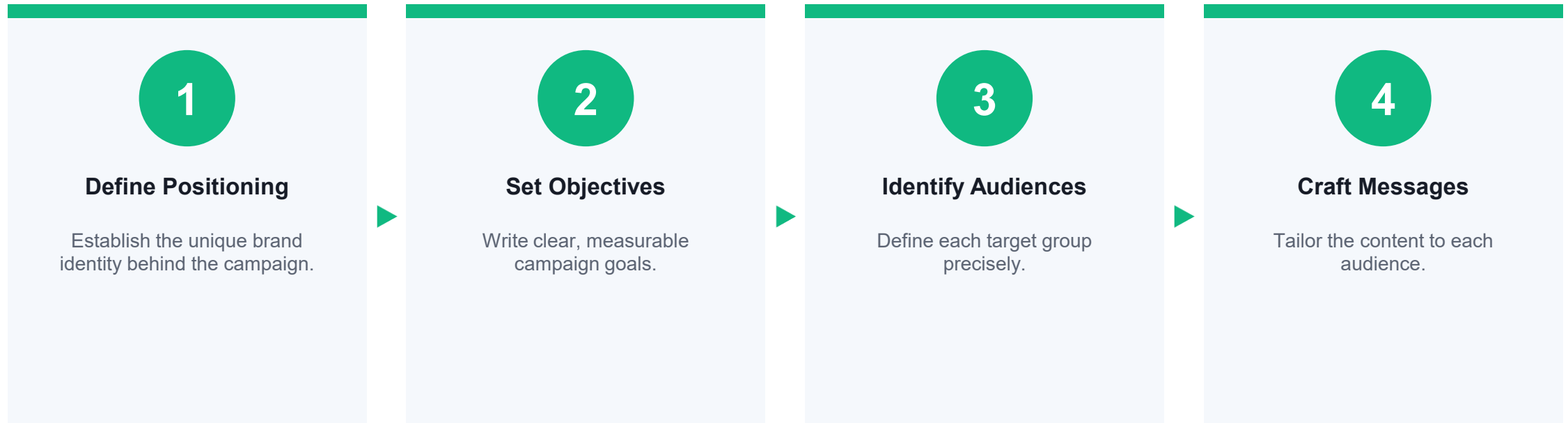
Resource allocation and cost control

4

Strategic Alignment

Everything traces back to one strategy

PR Campaign Planning Process



Budget Allocation Logic — Anchor vs Adjust

Anchor on Positioning

- Brand Fit First — every dollar traces back to the approved brand concept
- Owned as Base — the channels Nimbus controls carry the core story at near-zero cost
- Earned as Credibility — press and reviews lend outside validation paid media can't buy

Adjust for the Moment

- Paid to Fill Gaps — boosted reach only where owned and earned fall short
- Reserve for Response — budget held back for the CS perception gap resurfacing
- Review Mid-Campaign — reallocate if one channel is clearly outperforming the rest

The PESO Budget Model

1

Paid

Sponsored placements and promotion — reach money can buy directly.

2

Earned

Press coverage and reviews secured through relationships, unpaid.

3

Shared

Social conversation and community amplification around the brand.

4

Owned

Content on channels the brand fully controls — website, email, app.

Source: PESO Model (Paid, Earned, Shared, Owned), Gini Dietrich / Spin Sucks

Decades of Brand Investment, Not a Single Big Campaign

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Coca-Cola

Coca-Cola's dominance isn't one PR win — it's disciplined investment across earned press, owned channels and paid placement, sustained for decades rather than spent in a single burst. The same discipline should shape Nimbus's PESO split: a durable allocation, not a one-off relaunch spend.

PR Campaign Budget Planning

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

The CEO has approved a bounded PR budget for the 5th-anniversary relaunch — but not a blank cheque. Before a single dollar is spent, the CEO wants to see it allocated across earned, owned and paid channels in a way that visibly matches Nimbus's brand positioning, not just whichever channel the Marketing team finds easiest to book.

The Board has already flagged a second concern for after the relaunch: they want ongoing proof the campaign improved Nimbus's reputation, not just its impression count — so today's budget plan needs KPIs the Board can actually hold the team to.

Your table has been asked to build the PR budget proposal the CEO will sign off on.

You'll produce: A PR budget proposal with channel allocation and success metrics

Duration: 25 minutes

PR Campaign Budget Planning

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Using the PESO model, how should the budget split across paid, earned, shared and owned channels given Nimbus's brand positioning and the perception gap it's trying to close?

2

Which channel deserves the largest share of spend for this specific relaunch — and which would you deliberately underfund, and why?

3

What percentage, if any, should be held back as a reserve fund, and what would trigger Nimbus to actually spend it?

4

What KPIs would let the Board judge reputation improvement, not just reach or impressions?

PR Campaign Budget Planning

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your allocation favour the channel that's easiest to execute, or the one the brand positioning actually calls for?
- How did you decide the size of the reserve fund — was it a rule of thumb or tied to a specific risk Nimbus is facing?
- If the Board rejected your KPI list as "just vanity metrics," what would you replace them with?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a PR budget proposal with a percentage split across paid, earned, shared and owned channels, a stated reserve fund, and a KPI list the Board could use to judge reputation impact rather than reach alone.

Recap — Branding in Marketing

1

Brand Audit Workshop

You can now: Explain the basics of branding.

2

Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

You can now: Explain the role of branding in marketing.

3

Brand Activation Planning Workshop

You can now: Execute branding campaigns, events and activities to increase brand awareness.

4

PR Campaign Budget Planning

You can now: Execute public-relations campaigns in alignment to brand positioning strategies, operational plans and budget.

LU3 · WHY IT MATTERS

**A campaign can raise awareness in a week.
A brand earns trust over years — spend the
budget like you know the difference.**

— Closing thought, LU3: Branding in Marketing

LU4

Branding Effectiveness

Reputation Metrics · Success Indicators · PR Tactics · KPI Monitoring · Continuous Improvement

Key Concepts — Branding Effectiveness

1

Reputation is measured through social metrics, digital metrics (traffic, mentions) and business KPIs (NPS, satisfaction) across every platform the organisation touches.

2

Successful branding shows up in awareness, customer loyalty, financial impact and trust metrics — tracked consistently over time, not measured once.

3

Public-relations tactics — media relations, community outreach, crisis management and digital engagement — extend the brand's message beyond paid channels.

4

Monitoring the brand against SMART KPIs and acting on the gaps turns brand management into a continuous-improvement cycle rather than a one-off campaign.

LU4 · THE NEXT FRONTIER: AGENTIC AI

“The agent is becoming the brand.”

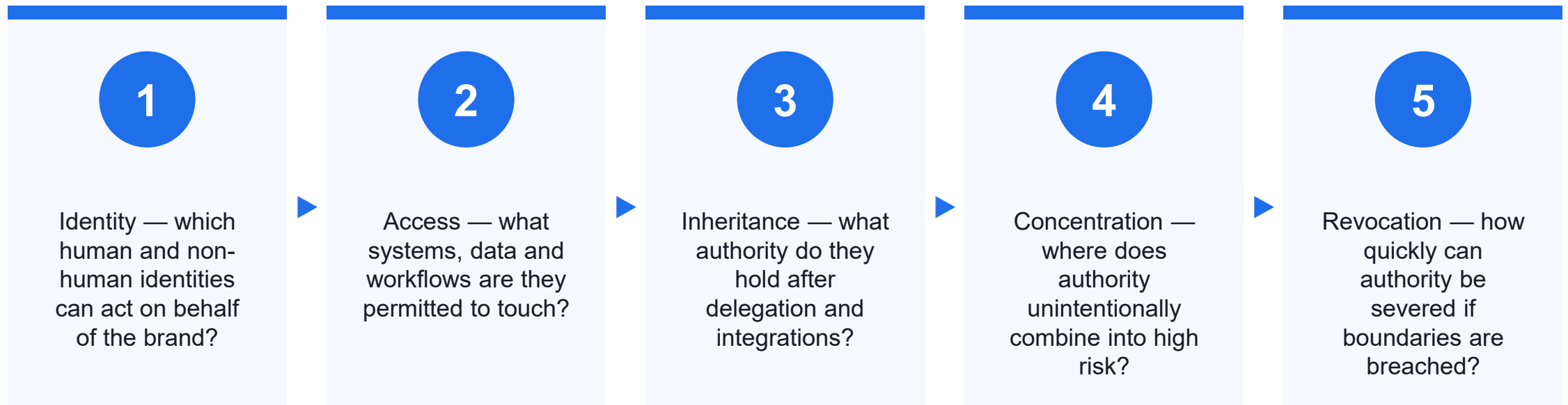
Nine in ten US marketing agencies now use generative AI, and half use agentic AI for execution. AI is no longer just generating content — it is deciding, spending, personalising and interacting directly with customers.

The Risk Vector: Authority Concentration



In an agentic enterprise, risk moves through authority pathways, not people. Human approvals cannot scale at machine speed to monitor these intersections.

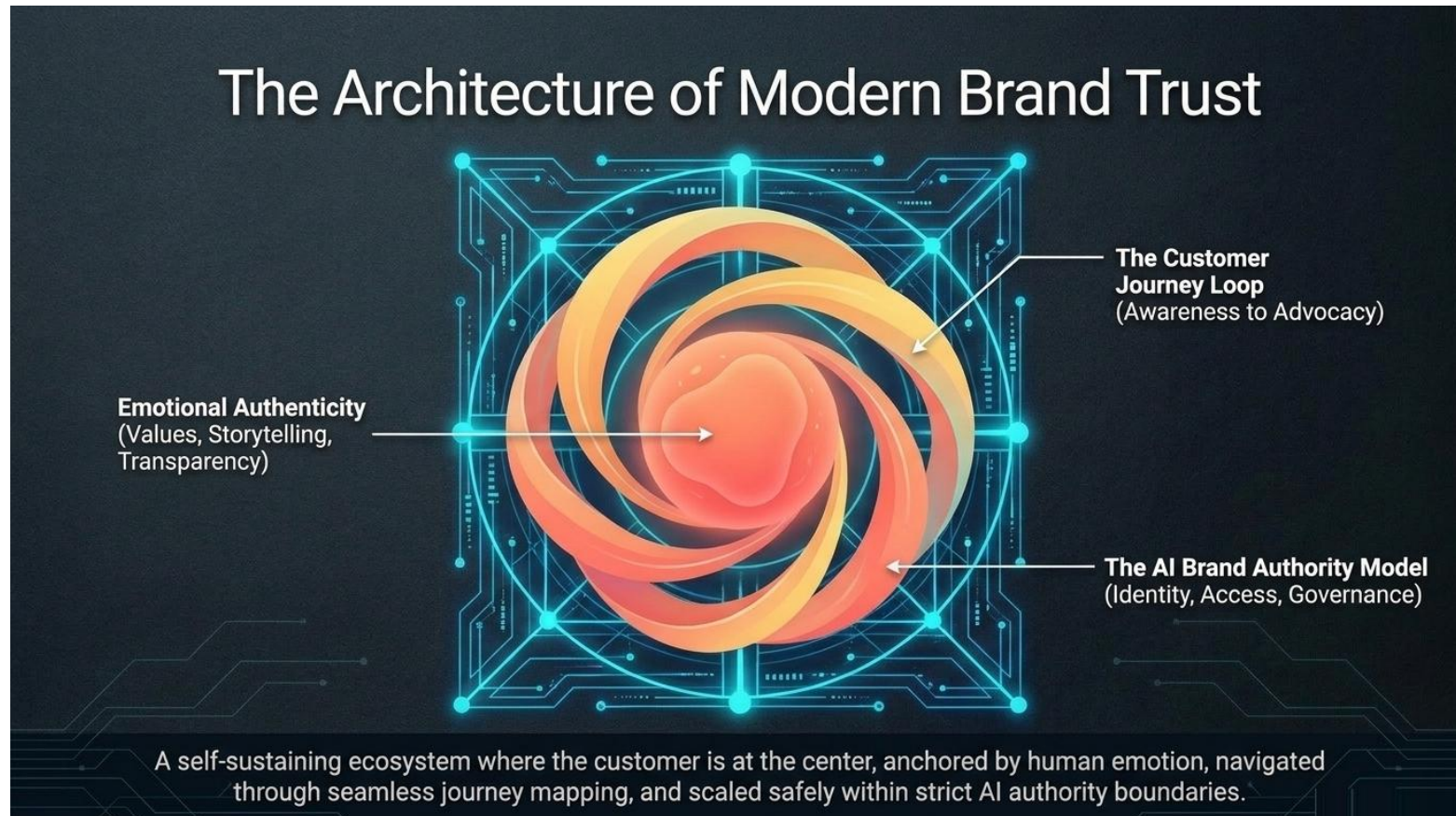
The Brand Authority Model



Enterprise Authority Assurance replaces the editorial calendar.

The Architecture of Modern Brand Trust

The customer at the centre — anchored by emotion, navigated through journey mapping, scaled safely within strict AI authority boundaries.



The Executive Playbook

01

Shift the Metric

Move away from pure acquisition costs. Restructure KPIs around lifetime value, Net Promoter Scores and journey retention.

02

Map the Reality, Not the Theory

Audit the 5-stage customer journey loop using actual behavioural data, not internal corporate assumptions. Find the friction.

03

Close the Say-Do Gap

Audit your brand's authenticity. Ensure marketing claims — environmental, social, quality — are rigidly matched by operational reality.

04

Build the Authority Model

Stop relying on human bottlenecks for AI approval. Map identity, access and authority concentration for every agentic system touching your brand.

Trust cannot be retrofitted. It must be engineered.

LO4 · LU4 · T1

Measures or indicators of organisation's reputation on different platforms

What is Measures or indicators of organisation's reputation on different platforms?

1

Social Media

Followers, engagement and sentiment tracked live

2

Digital Metrics

Website traffic, search rankings, brand mentions

3

Business KPIs

NPS, satisfaction and financial impact

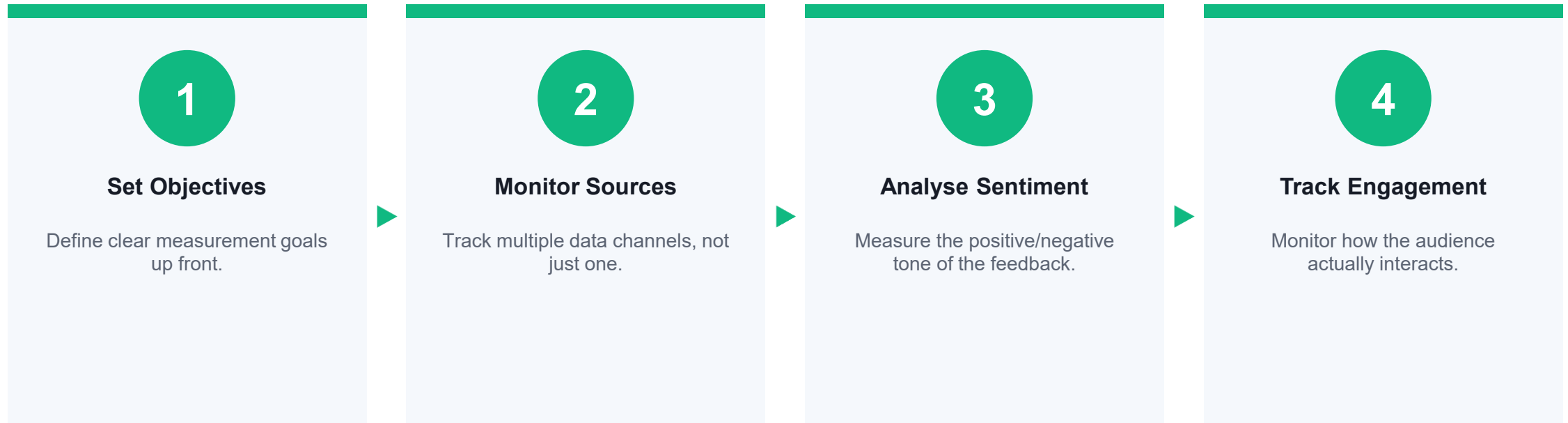
4

Stakeholder Data

Customer, employee and investor perceptions

Source: Meltwater, 2024

Reputation Monitoring Process



Traditional vs Modern Reputation Monitoring

Traditional

- Single Channel — limited platform coverage
- Reactive — response only after issues occur
- Basic Metrics — simple measurement tools

Modern

- Multi-Platform — comprehensive cross-channel tracking
- Predictive — forecasts stakeholder behaviour patterns
- AI Analytics — real-time sentiment analysis

Where Nimbus's Reputation Is Actually Built

1

Customer Actions

Discover: Sees an ad or search result; Browse: Reads reviews, compares options; Purchase: Buys online or in-store; Post-Purchase: Posts a review or complaint

2

Frontstage

Discover: Social post, search ranking; Browse: Product page, shelf display; Purchase: Checkout, staff interaction; Post-Purchase: Review reply, service chat

3

Backstage

Discover: Content team tracks mentions; Browse: Merchandising tracks page analytics; Purchase: Fulfilment team processes order; Post-Purchase: Support team logs sentiment

4

Support

Discover: Monitoring tool flags mentions; Browse: Analytics dashboard tracks traffic; Purchase: CRM records purchase history; Post-Purchase: Alert tool flags negative posts

Source: service-blueprint methodology (Shostack, 1984, adapted); Meltwater, 2024

One Reputation, Measured Across a Dozen Touchpoints at Once

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Grab

Grab's reputation lives in app ratings, driver reviews, social media and news coverage simultaneously — a single bad headline can move all four at once, which is why a platform audit can't treat any one channel in isolation.

Platform Reputation Audit

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

Three weeks after Nimbus Wellness's 5th-anniversary relaunch went live, the founder is celebrating a spike in impressions and website traffic. The Board isn't satisfied with raw numbers, though — it wants to know whether the relaunch actually repaired the "doesn't feel personal anymore" perception gap uncovered before the campaign, or just produced a short-term spike in attention.

Marketing has a folder of screenshots — likes, shares, a handful of glowing reviews — but no one has compared this to what reputation looked like before the relaunch, or checked the platforms customers actually complain on, like Google reviews and the wellness retail chain's own app.

Before Marketing reports back to the Board next week, your table must build the audit that separates real reputation movement from relaunch-week noise.

You'll produce: A platform-by-platform reputation audit (3+ platforms) with leading and lagging indicators tracked, and a leadership-ready read on whether the relaunch actually shifted reputation

Duration: 20 minutes

Platform Reputation Audit

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Which 3 platforms will actually tell you whether Nimbus's reputation has shifted since the relaunch — not just which platforms have the most impressions?

2

Which of your chosen metrics are leading indicators that warn of a problem early, and which are lagging indicators that only confirm what already happened?

3

How would you separate a genuine sentiment shift on "feels personal again" from a short-term spike caused by relaunch hype alone?

4

What would you tell the Board next week if the quantitative numbers looked good but the qualitative comments never mentioned feeling more "personal" at all?

Platform Reputation Audit

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your table lean too heavily on quantitative metrics before someone asked what the qualitative comments actually said?
- Which platform did you almost leave out of the audit — and why did it turn out to matter?
- If the relaunch metrics stay strong for one more month and then fade, what would that suggest about whether the reputation gap was really closed?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a platform-by-platform audit naming at least one leading and one lagging indicator per platform, and can state in one sentence whether the evidence shows a genuine reputation shift or just a relaunch-week spike.

LO4 · LU4 · T2

Indicators of successful branding

What is Indicators of successful branding?

1

Brand Awareness

Recognition and recall measured directly

2

Customer Loyalty

Retention and repeat-purchase rates tracked

3

Financial Impact

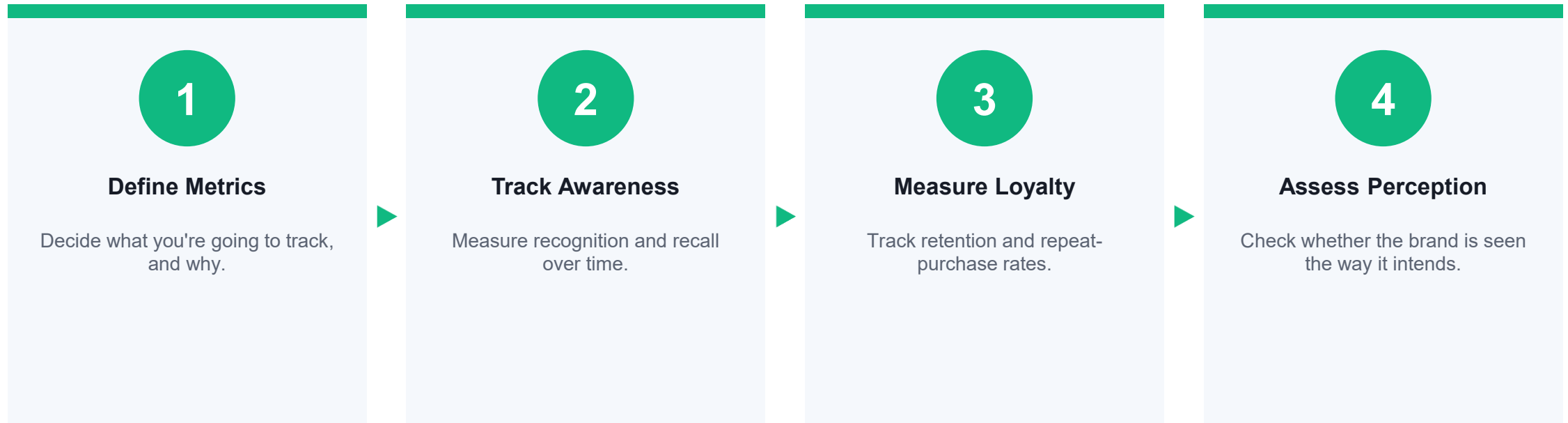
Revenue growth and market share

4

Trust Metrics

Consumer confidence and perception measured

Brand Measurement Framework



Traditional vs Digital Brand Measurement

Traditional

- Surveys — customer feedback collection
- Focus Groups — qualitative brand perception
- Quarterly — periodic assessment cycles

Digital

- Analytics — real-time performance tracking
- Social Media — engagement and sentiment monitoring
- Continuous — always-on measurement

The Four Brand Health Pillars

1

Awareness

Do people recognise Nimbus unprompted, and recall it against name-brand competitors?

2

Loyalty

Do existing customers keep coming back, and how many repeat-purchase within a season?

3

Financial Impact

Is brand strength actually translating into revenue growth and share of category spend?

4

Trust

Do customers believe Nimbus's claims and feel confident recommending it to a friend?

Source: Brand Health Tracking Best Practices, 2024; NPS industry benchmarks, 2025 (illustrative)

Brand Health Is a Tracked Metric, Not a One-Off Survey

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

DBS Bank

DBS's widely-reported "World's Best Bank" recognition wasn't a lucky survey result — it was built on years of measurable digital and customer-experience metrics tracked continuously, the same discipline Nimbus needs to prove ongoing brand health to its Board.

Brand Health Assessment

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

The Board's real question isn't "did the relaunch get noticed" — it's whether Nimbus's brand is genuinely healthier than it was six months ago. Marketing has awareness numbers on hand, but no one has looked at loyalty, financial impact or trust together.

The founder is due to present a "State of the Brand" update to the Board in two weeks, right after the relaunch's first full sales cycle closes. She has asked your table for a one-page brand-health scorecard she can defend line by line.

Customer Service has also noticed something odd: several long-time customers who complained the brand "feels distant" are now leaving five-star reviews again — but repeat-purchase data hasn't moved yet.

You'll produce: A brand-health scorecard across all four pillars (Awareness, Loyalty, Financial Impact, Trust) with evidence and one improvement action for the weakest pillar

Duration: 25 minutes

Brand Health Assessment

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Across Awareness, Loyalty, Financial Impact and Trust, which pillar is Nimbus strongest on right now, and which is weakest — and what evidence would prove it either way?

2

The reviews have improved but repeat-purchase data hasn't moved — which pillar does that gap sit in, and what does it tell the founder about how long a real recovery actually takes?

3

If you could only fund one more month of measurement in a single pillar, which would move the Board's confidence most, and why?

4

What separates a brand-health indicator the Board should act on immediately from one that's just worth watching?

Brand Health Assessment

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Which pillar did your table find hardest to find real evidence for — awareness, loyalty, financial impact or trust?
- Did the group's instinct about Nimbus's strongest pillar match what the evidence actually showed?
- If financial impact keeps lagging the other three pillars for another quarter, is that a marketing problem or an operations problem?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show a one-page scorecard rating Nimbus on all four pillars with named evidence for each rating, plus one improvement action for the weakest pillar.

LO4 · LU4 · T3

Public relations tactics

What is Public relations tactics?

1

Media Relations

Build journalist partnerships for visibility

2

Community Outreach

Engage local audiences and stakeholders

3

Crisis Management

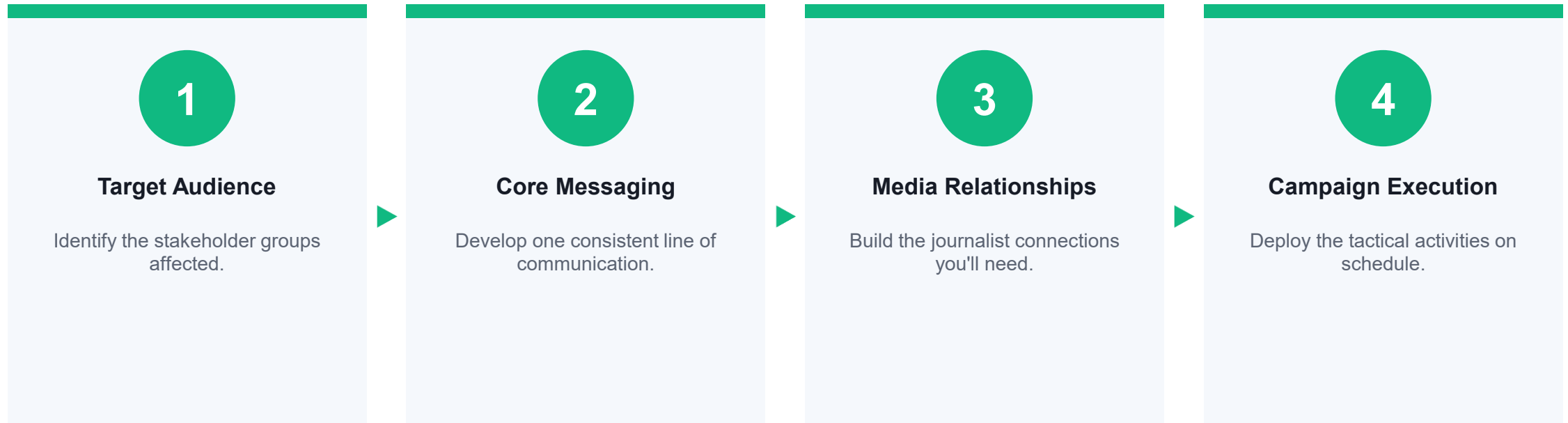
Protect reputation during a challenge

4

Digital Engagement

Social media and online interactions

PR Implementation Process



Reactive vs Proactive Crisis Response

Reactive — Defensive & Silent

- Wait for Full Certainty — Cracker Barrel's 2025 rebrand backlash festered for a week before the company reversed course — and revenue still fell roughly 6% that quarter, even after the reversal.
- Deny or Minimise — Downplaying a complaint thread as "a few unhappy customers" reads as dismissive once hundreds of people are sharing their own photos.
- Let Silence Fill the Vacuum — An information vacuum left by delay gets filled by critics, not facts — the story gets written without you in it.

Proactive — Fast & Transparent

- Confirm and Communicate Fast — McDonald's 2024 E. coli response traced the supply-chain source quickly and shared an improvement plan across multiple platforms before the story could spiral.
- Give Frequent, Plain-Language Updates — Slack's 2025 outage updates used a public status page with timestamped, plain-language updates — transparency about the technical problem built trust instead of breaking it.
- Publish the Full Explanation After — Slack followed each outage with a full post-incident explanation — closing the loop shows the company learned, not just reacted.

Source: PR crisis-management case examples, 2024-2025 (McDonald's, Slack, Cracker Barrel)

The Nimbus Crisis Response Fork

1

The Fork

A defective-product video is going viral the night before Nimbus's biggest interview — what happens tonight?

2

Stay Silent — Silence Fills the Vacuum

Critics and the journalist write the story for Nimbus — "knew and hid it" becomes the headline.

3

Respond Fast — Trust Preserved

Confirm what's known, commit to a fix, and give an honest on-record line before tomorrow's interview.

4

Escalate Fully — Crisis Protocol Activated

For a widespread defect: recall affected units, activate the crisis team, notify every platform at once.

Source: crisis-communication decision frameworks; PR Strategy Essentials, 2024

The Textbook Case: Fast, Transparent, Costly — and Trust-Preserving

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Johnson & Johnson

When cyanide-laced Tylenol capsules killed seven people in 1982, Johnson & Johnson pulled every bottle from shelves nationwide within days and introduced the tamper-proof packaging the whole industry later adopted — still taught today as the standard for fast, transparent crisis response.

PR Crisis Response Plan

ROLE PLAY

THE SITUATION

It's 9pm, the night before the founder's biggest relaunch media interview yet. A customer posts a video of her new Nimbus jar — from the new sustainable packaging line launched with the anniversary campaign — cracked and leaking product, captioned "the 'eco-friendly' packaging Nimbus is so proud of." Within two hours it has hundreds of shares and a wave of other customers replying with their own photos.

Operations thinks it may be a single bad batch from the new packaging supplier, but can't confirm numbers until morning. The journalist doing tomorrow's interview has already seen the thread and has emailed asking whether Nimbus knew about a defect before launch.

The founder wants to say nothing until Operations has the full facts — but the thread is growing every hour, and tomorrow's interview is unavoidable. Your group must decide what Nimbus does tonight, and what the spokesperson says tomorrow morning.

You'll produce: A same-night crisis-response script (public statement + next-day interview line) rehearsed through the three roles, benchmarked against a real 2024-2025 crisis example

Duration: 25 minutes

PR Crisis Response Plan

ASSIGN THE ROLES

Spokesperson

GOAL

Represent Nimbus publicly without over-promising

Must decide what Nimbus can credibly say before every fact is confirmed, and how much to reveal in tomorrow's interview.

Journalist

GOAL

Get a real, on-record answer for tomorrow's story

Already has screenshots of the complaint thread and will ask directly whether Nimbus knew about the packaging issue before the relaunch.

Crisis-Response Lead

GOAL

Coordinate the facts and the fix before Nimbus says anything publicly

Is still confirming with Operations exactly how many units are affected, and whether it's a supplier fault or a Nimbus quality-control miss.

PR Crisis Response Plan

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Is staying silent until Operations confirms every fact actually the safer choice tonight, or does it leave a vacuum the thread will fill for Nimbus?

2

What can the Spokesperson honestly commit to in tomorrow's interview before the root cause is even confirmed?

3

How should the Crisis-Response Lead's internal fact-finding and the Spokesperson's public statement stay in sync without one getting ahead of the other?

4

What would Nimbus need to say and do in the first 24 hours to be judged as fast and transparent rather than defensive?

PR Crisis Response Plan

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Did your Spokesperson end up promising more, or less, than Nimbus could actually deliver by morning?
- Where did the Journalist's questions expose a gap between what the Crisis-Response Lead knew and what the Spokesperson said?
- Looking at the Cracker Barrel and McDonald's examples, which pattern did your group's response end up closer to — and was that a deliberate choice?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can perform or narrate a same-night response that names what Nimbus confirms publicly within hours, what it says in tomorrow's interview, and a follow-up commitment — and can point to which real-world example (fast/transparent vs delayed/silent) their plan resembles.

LO4 · LU4 · T4

Monitor the success of the brand against Key Performance Indicators (KPI)

What is Monitor the success of the brand against Key Performance Indicators (KPI)?

1

SMART KPIs

Specific, measurable, attainable, realistic, time-bound

2

Data Collection

Analytics tools and brand guidelines

3

Performance Analysis

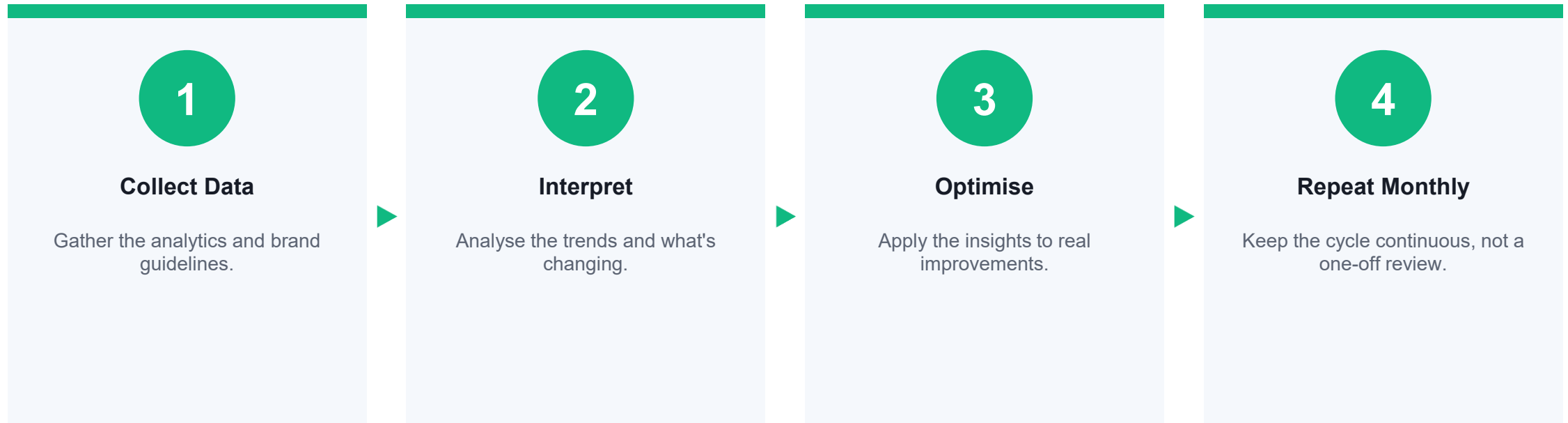
Interpret trends and what's changing

4

Strategic Optimisation

Insights drive real brand improvements

KPI Monitoring Process



Brand KPI Categories — Internal vs External Focus

Internal Focus

- Team Adoption — brand-guideline compliance
- Consistency — cross-channel brand alignment
- Engagement — internal brand activation

External Focus

- Market Perception — customer brand sentiment
- Competitive Position — market-share comparison
- Awareness — brand recognition metrics

The SMART KPI Model

1

Specific

Name exactly what's being measured — not "brand awareness" in general, but unprompted recall among Nimbus's core segment.

2

Measurable

State how it's quantified — percentage, score or count — and where the number comes from.

3

Attainable

Set a target Nimbus can realistically move given its size and budget, not an aspirational guess.

4

Realistic

Tie the KPI to something the brand can actually influence, not a market force outside its control.

5

Time-bound

Give the KPI a review deadline — monthly, quarterly — so it forces a real decision, not a standing report.

Source: SMART goal-setting framework (Doran, 1981, adapted); Frontify, 2024

A Culture Built Around Measurable Goals

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Google

Google's well-known OKR (Objectives and Key Results) practice ties every team's work to a small set of measurable, time-bound goals reviewed on a regular cycle — the same discipline behind a SMART KPI framework.

KPI Dashboard Design

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

The Board's ask is specific: it wants a KPI framework it can check every month after the relaunch, not a one-off report from Marketing whenever someone remembers to send it. The founder, who is not a numbers person, has asked for something she can read in five minutes and still trust.

Right now every department tracks something different — Marketing watches follower counts, Retail watches footfall, Customer Service watches response times — and none of it is compared against a target or a deadline. Last month someone reported "engagement is up" without saying up from what, or by when it should keep rising.

Your table's job is to turn this scattered activity into a small set of SMART KPIs the Board can actually govern the relaunch by.

You'll produce: A SMART KPI framework (3 internal + 3 external KPIs) with an owner, target, data source and review deadline for each

Duration: 20 minutes

KPI Dashboard Design

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Which 3 internal and 3 external KPIs would actually tell the Board whether the relaunch is working — not just which numbers are easiest for each department to pull?

2

Take one of your KPIs through the full SMART test — where does it break down first, and how do you fix that?

3

Who owns each KPI, and what happens if the number misses target two months in a row?

4

If the Board can only look at one dashboard slide, what's the smallest set of numbers that still tells the whole story?

KPI Dashboard Design

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Which of your KPIs was hardest to make genuinely Measurable rather than just a description of activity?
- Did your table set a target that was Attainable, or did ambition win out over realism?
- If one KPI is red for two straight months, does your framework actually say what happens next — or does it stop at reporting the number?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can show 3 internal + 3 external KPIs, each SMART-tested with a named owner, target, data source and review deadline, and can explain what action a missed target would trigger.

LO4 · LU4 · T5

Provide suggestions to improve public relations campaign effectiveness

What is Provide suggestions to improve public relations campaign effectiveness?

1

Performance Gaps

Find weaknesses through data analysis

2

Strategic Planning

Set measurable objectives and tactics

3

Media Relations

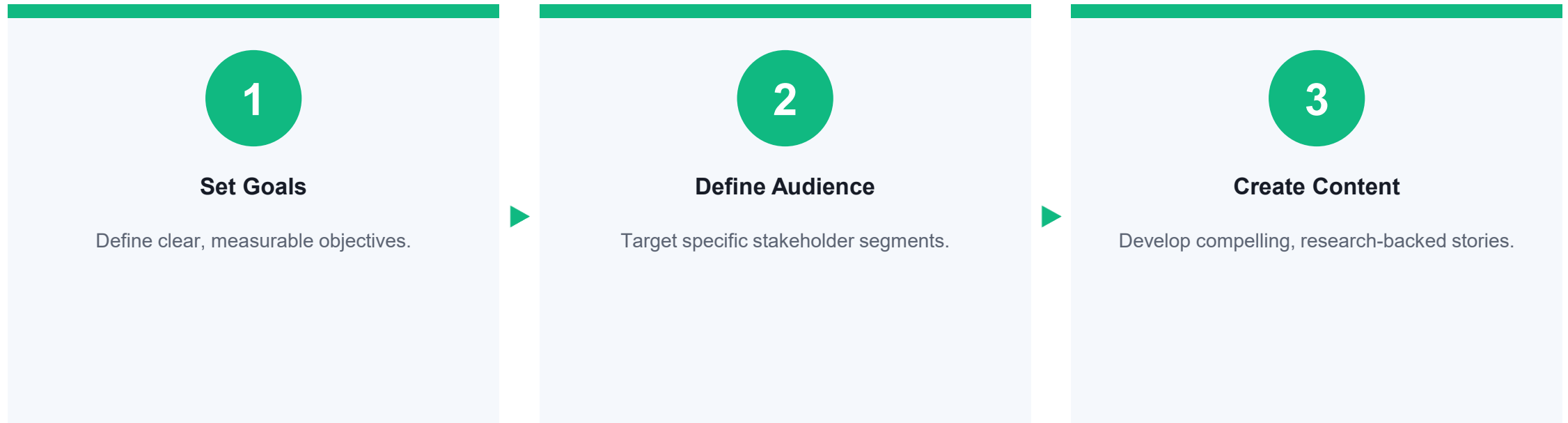
Build strong journalist partnerships

4

Content Quality

Create compelling, research-backed stories

Campaign Optimisation Process



Output Metrics vs Outcome Metrics

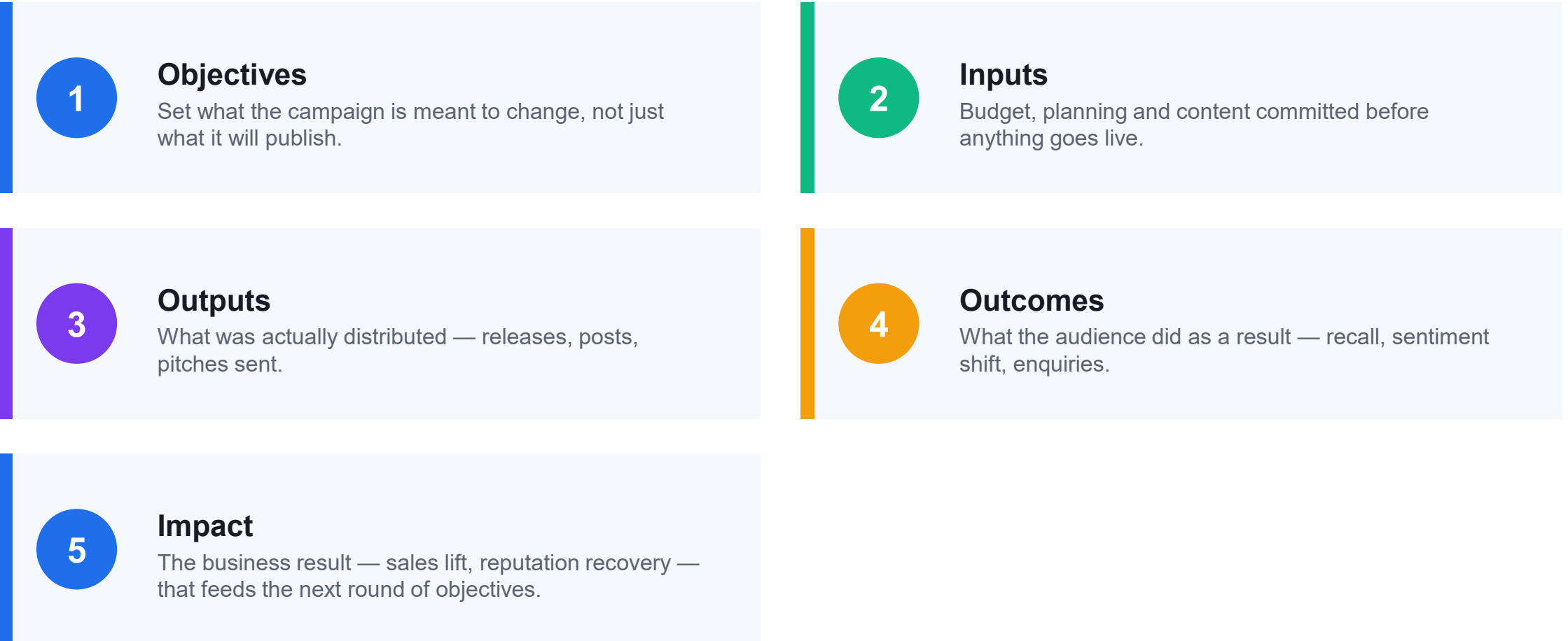
Output Metrics

- Reach — total audience exposure
- Impressions — content visibility metrics
- Volume — quantity of coverage

Outcome Metrics

- Business Impact — revenue and growth correlation
- Behaviour Change — audience action and engagement
- Quality Metrics — message penetration and sentiment

The AMEC Evaluation Loop



Source: AMEC Integrated Evaluation Framework; Barcelona Principles 4.0 (2025)

Two Decades of Tracked Impact, Not Just One Campaign

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Dove

Unilever's Dove "Real Beauty" campaign is one of the most measured PR campaigns in marketing history — tracked for over 20 years against brand-trust and sales metrics, the same Outcomes-to-Impact discipline an AMEC-style audit asks Nimbus to apply.

PR Campaign Audit Exercise

CASE STUDY

THE SITUATION

It's now two months after the 5th-anniversary relaunch. The Board has seen the KPI dashboard designed in the last activity, and the numbers are mixed: impressions are up sharply, but the "doesn't feel personal anymore" sentiment has only partly recovered, and one retail partner is still hesitant to expand shelf space.

The founder wants one final audit before she reports to the Board — not a scorecard of what Nimbus did, but a verdict on whether the relaunch campaign actually worked, and three concrete recommendations for what happens next.

This is the same audit the Board will expect Nimbus to repeat after every future campaign — so your table isn't just closing out the relaunch, it's building the habit the brand will run on going forward.

You'll produce: An AMEC-based campaign audit (Inputs/Outputs/Outcomes/Impact) with three stage-specific recommendations for the next campaign

Duration: 25 minutes

PR Campaign Audit Exercise

DISCUSSION & DECISION PROMPTS

1

Run the relaunch campaign through AMEC's Inputs → Outputs → Outcomes → Impact chain — at which stage does the evidence get weakest?

2

Impressions are up but the "feels personal" sentiment has only partly recovered — is that an Outputs success but an Outcomes failure, or something else?

3

What would you tell the founder is the single biggest gap between what Nimbus measured and what the Board actually needed to know?

4

What three recommendations would you make for the next campaign, and which AMEC stage does each one fix?

PR Campaign Audit Exercise

REFLECT & DISCUSS

- Looking back across all five LU4 activities, which measurement habit would have caught today's gap earliest — the reputation audit, the brand-health scorecard, or the KPI dashboard?
- Did your table's recommendations fix the root cause, or just add another metric to track?
- If Nimbus only adopts one habit from this whole course to run every future campaign by, what should it be?

✓ Facilitator debrief check

Every group can map the relaunch campaign to all four AMEC stages (Inputs, Outputs, Outcomes, Impact), name the weakest stage with evidence, and give three recommendations that each fix a different stage — not three versions of the same idea.

Recap — Branding Effectiveness

1

Platform Reputation Audit

You can now: Identify measures or indicators of the organisation's reputation on different platforms.

2

Brand Health Assessment

You can now: Recognise the indicators of successful branding.

3

PR Crisis Response Plan

You can now: Apply public-relations tactics.

4

KPI Dashboard Design

You can now: Monitor the success of the brand against Key Performance Indicators (KPI).

5

PR Campaign Audit Exercise

You can now: Provide suggestions to improve public-relations campaign effectiveness.

LU4 · WHY IT MATTERS

What gets measured against a SMART target gets improved. Everything else just gets opinions.

— Closing thought, LU4: Branding Effectiveness

The Customer-Centric Branding Playbook

01

Map Before You Message

Know every stakeholder's real power, interest and concern before you speak to them (LU1).

02

Listen Before You Assume

Capture the actual customer perception gap through active listening, not internal belief (LU2).

03

Brand Before You Campaign

Anchor every awareness and PR activity to one consistent brand positioning (LU3).

04

Measure to Improve

Track reputation against SMART KPIs and treat every gap as the next action (LU4).

Trust cannot be retrofitted after the relaunch. It has to be engineered into every stakeholder, every customer conversation, every campaign and every KPI along the way.



WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

What You Achieved

1

Stakeholders & Organisation

Mapped stakeholders and audiences; drafted brand designs and reputation assessments.

2

Customer Influence

Captured and documented customer perception through active listening.

3

Branding in Marketing

Executed branding and PR campaigns aligned to strategy, plan and budget.

4

Branding Effectiveness

Measured reputation and PR performance against KPIs and proposed improvements.

Assessment

1

Written Assessment (WA)

SAQ — 1 hour, open book.

2

Case Study (CS)

1 hour, open book.

3

Open Book

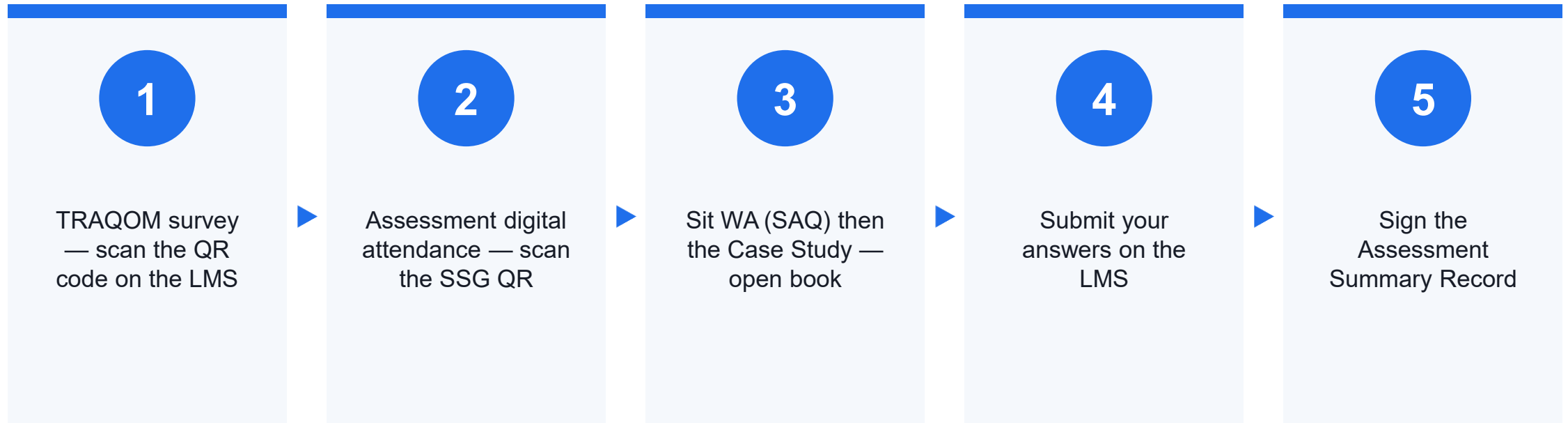
Slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.

4

Submit

On the LMS — lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

Assessment Flow



Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

It is mandatory to take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance for WSQ-funded courses.

2

The trainer/administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.

3

Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.

4

A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

SEE YOU AT THE NEXT ONE

Thank You!

You are now equipped to build customer-centric brand communication that earns trust and drives results.